NAMIBIA

CROP PROSPECTS, FOOD SECURITY AND DROUGHT SITUATION REPORT

MARCH 2019

HIGHLIGHTS

The 2018/2019-rainfall season has been extremely poor and was seen in the forms of delayed onset of the rainfall season, sporadic and erratic rainfall patterns as well as frequent prolonged dry spells compounded by extremely high temperatures that exacerbated evaporation of the little moisture received. This is said to have affected the agricultural production and water resources. According to the Namibia Meteorological Services rainfall report, March 2019 was the fifth consecutive month with suppressed rainfall over the large part of the country.

Provisional crop estimates, indicated that all crop-producing areas are expecting massive reductions in the expected harvest. Aggregate cereal production shows that the country is expecting a substantial reduction in harvest of at least 53% of last season's harvest and over 42% below the average production. This reduction is largely attributed to the general poor rainfall received during the 2018/2019-rainfall season.

Household food security remained satisfactory in most regions of the country, following good improvements in agricultural production recorded in the last two seasons. The situation is however expected to weaken as from the next harvest (May 2019) amidst poor crop production referred to above. Pockets of food insecurity are also still being reported in various areas especially those that suffered poor agricultural production due to prolonged dry spells or floods during the 2017/2018 rainfall season coupled with the current ongoing drought conditions in the country.

Grazing conditions continue to deteriorate in most parts of the country in the midst of very poor and below average rainfall conditions experienced countrywide. In most areas, grazing is reported to vary between fair to poor (in Zambezi, Kavango West and Kavango East regions) to very poor elsewhere in the country. The central, southern, north central and the north western regions of the country are the most affected and livestock mortalities as a result of malnutrition were reported.

This report was prepared by the Namibia Early Warning and Food Information Unit (NEWFIU) with information from official and unofficial sources.
Since conditions may change rapidly, please contact the undersigned for further information if required.
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Table of Contents

1.0 OVERVIEW 2

2.0 AGRO-METEOROLOGICAL INFORMATION..... 3

3.0 CROP PRODUCTION PROSPECTS 7

4.0 FOOD SECURITY SITUATION 9

5.0 PASTURE, LIVESTOCK AND WATER SUPPLY SITUATION 11

6.0 DAMS LEVELS..... 15

7.0 REGIONAL CROP AND FOOD SECURITY SITUATION 16

8.0 NATIONAL CEREAL PRODUCTION SITUATION ANALYSIS FOR 2018/2019 CROPPING SEASON. 51

9.0 CEREAL FOOD SUPPLY AND DEMAND SITUATION UPDATE 53

10.0. CONCLUTION AND RECOMMENDATIONS 54

11.0 ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS..... 56

OVERVIEW

The Agro Business Information Services is responsible for the National Early Warning and Food Information System (NEWFIS) in the Ministry of Agriculture, Water and Forestry. Usually, NEWFIS in collaboration with its cooperating partners conduct the first Crop and Household Food Security Monitoring Assessment in the seven northern major communal crop producing regions[1] during February each year. The main purpose of the assessment are to assess crop conditions in the major crop-growing regions and provide early warning report on geographic locations of agronomic anomalies, the effects of floods, droughts, and other significant events. The assessment also looks at changes in household food security, livestock and grazing conditions.

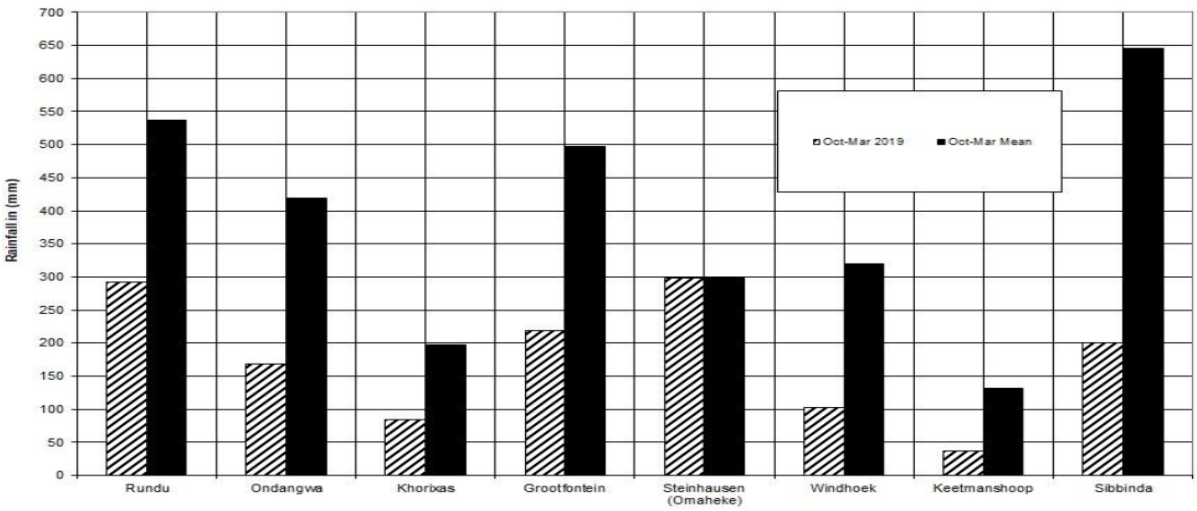
However, due to technical difficulties experienced this year, NEWFIS was unable to conduct the assessment. Nevertheless, NEWFIS has liaised with the Regional Agricultural Extension offices that gathered information related to rainfall performance, crop production, grazing and livestock conditions as well as water supply situation. Other secondary information used was obtained from the Namibian Agronomic Board (NAB), Agricultural Marketing and Trade Agency (AMTA) and Directorate of Veterinary Services (DVS).

[1] Major communal crop producing regions included Zambezi, Kavango East, Kavango West, Omusati, Ohangwena, Oshana and Oshikoto region

2018/2019 Rainfall Performances for Namibia

The 2018/2019-rainfall season was extremely poor with unprecedented rainfall patterns. Firstly, the rainfall season was delayed for at least two month as productive rainfall was received end of December to early January as opposed to end of October to early November. Even then, rainfall performance has been very poor and was seen in the forms of sporadic and erratic rainfall patterns with frequent prolonged dry spells accompanied by high temperatures. Subsequently, the agricultural production and the water supply systems were severely affected. According to the Namibia Meteorological Services rainfall report, March 2019 was the fifth consecutive month with suppressed rainfall over the bulk of the country. The report noted that, during February and March, most of the rainfall reporting stations showed high negative departures from normal except over areas surrounding Ngoma (Zambezi), Maltahohe (Hardap) and southeastern parts of the country. It was further reported that, most areas over the southeastern of the country only received their first rains of the season during February 2019 (see Fig. 1 and Fig. 2 below).

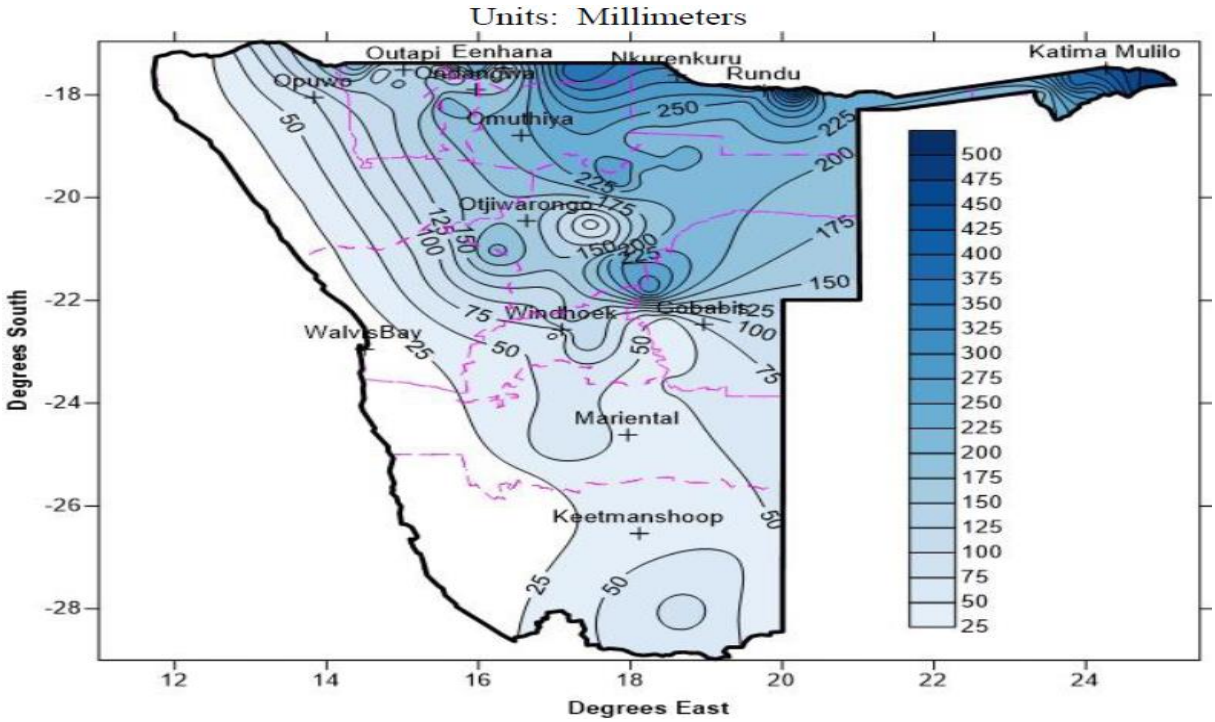
Figure 1: Rainfall Relative Performance Chat - October 2018 to March 2019 relative to Normal in various towns in Namibia



Sources: Meteorological Services of Namibia

Figure 2 above shows that the country received below normal rainfall between October 2018 and March 2019. The Namibian Meteorological Services report noted that, the bulk of the country recorded negative departures on seasonal scale (October 2018 to February 2019) with very few exceptions. The report concluded that seasonal rainfall deficit remain highest over the northern parts where between 120 to over 200mm is required to normalize the rainy season, while the central areas require between 100 and 160 and southern parts about 40 to 100mm.

Fig 2: Cumulative Seasonal Rainfall - October 2018 to March 2019



Sources: Meteorological Services of Namibia

Reports from various regions in the country indicated poor rainfall performance experienced between October 2018 and March 2019, causing poor crop germinations as well as the wilting of both crops and grazing. Poor and below average rainfall did not only affect the agricultural production, but also worsened the water supply, particularly in areas that are heavily dependent on the surface/rainfall water. At the time of this report most of the water catchments (e.g. earth dams, ponds, Iishana), are either dry or has very little water level to sustain livestock and in some areas also human consumption.

SADC Rainfall forecast for March to May 2019 period

March-April-May 2019

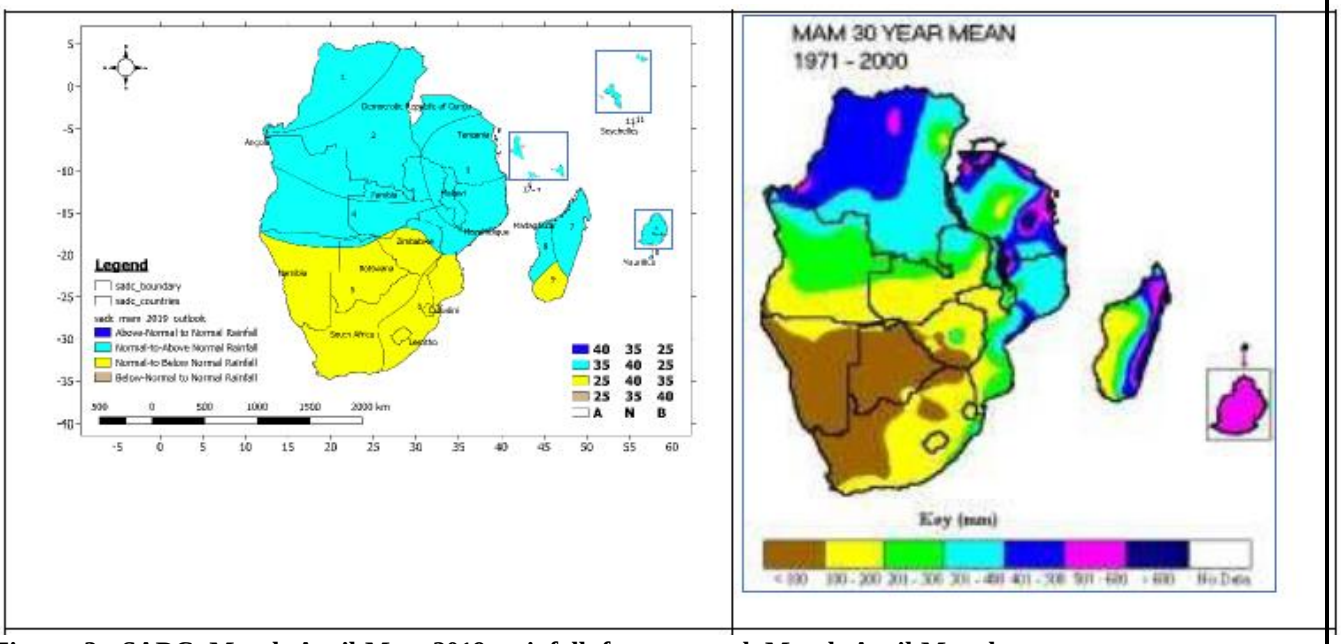


Figure 3: SADC March-April-May 2019 rainfall forecast and March-April-May long-term average rainfall
Sources: SARCOF 22

Zone 1: North-western most DRC.
Increased chances of normal to above-normal rainfall
Zone 2: North-eastern most of Tanzania, bulk of DRC, northern half of Angola and northern Zambia.
Increased chances of normal to above-normal rainfall
Zone 3: Northern Mozambique, bulk of Tanzania, Malawi and eastern Zambia.
Increased chances of normal to above-normal rainfall
Zone 4: Southern Zambia, north-eastern Zimbabwe, central parts of Mozambique, northernmost Botswana, northernmost Namibia and half of Angola.
Increased chances of normal to above-normal rainfall
Zone 5: Southern half of Zimbabwe, bulk of Botswana, bulk of South Africa and bulk of Namibia.
Increased chances of normal to below-normal rainfall
Zone 6: Southern Mozambique, eastern fringes of Zimbabwe, eastern parts of South Africa Lesotho and Eswatini.
Increased chances of normal to below-normal rainfall
Zone 7: North-eastern Madagascar.
Increased chances of normal to above-normal rainfall
Zone 8: Western Madagascar.
Increased chances of normal to above-normal rainfall
Zone 9: Southernmost Madagascar.
Increased chances of normal to below-normal rainfall
Zone 10: Mauritius
Increased chances of normal to above-normal rainfall
Zone 11: Seychelles.
Increased chances of normal to above-normal rainfall
Zone 12: Comoros. Increased chances of normal to above-normal rainfall

Namibia Rainfall forecast for March to April 2019 period

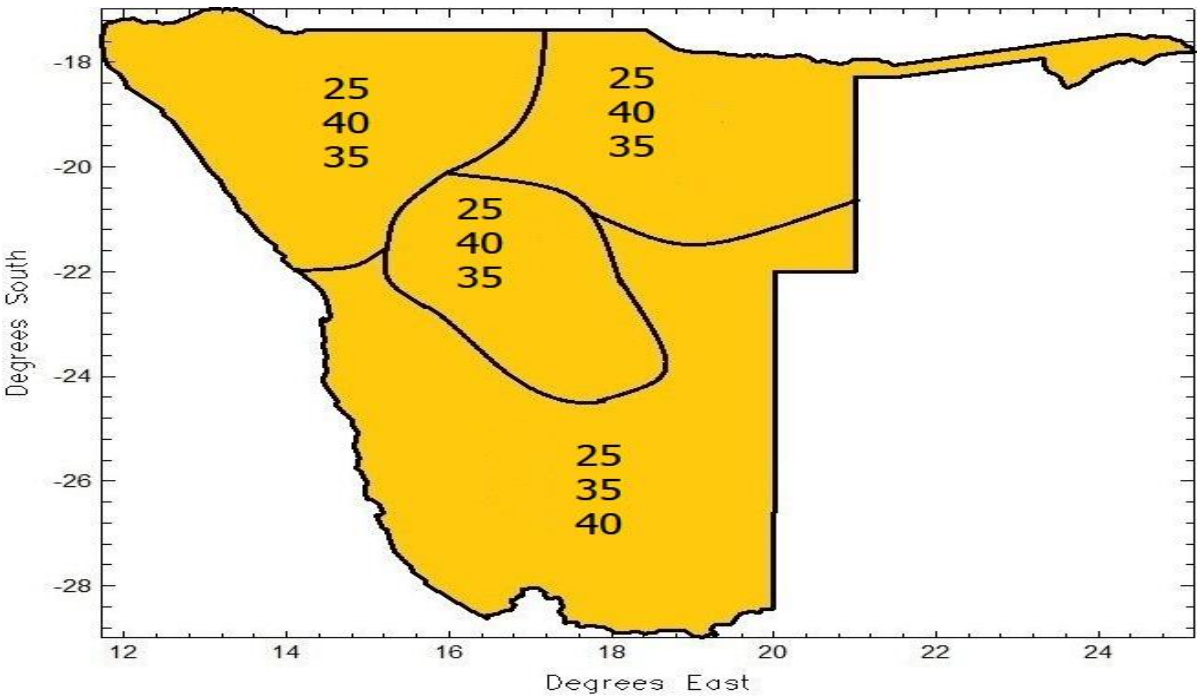


Figure 4: Namibia March to April 2019 rainfall forecast

Sources: Meteorological Services of Namibia

Figure 4 show the rainfall outlook for the remainder of the season for Namibia. The outlook indicated normal to below normal rainfall in the bulk of the country with most parts of the southern regions anticipated to receive below normal-to-normal rainfall.

CROP PRODUCTION PROSPECTS

Due to the prevailing drought conditions which are currently ongoing in the country, all crop producing regions are expecting a very poor and below average crop production this season. According to the provisional crop estimates, all major communal crop producing regions and commercial rain-fed cereal crop producers are expecting a massive reduction in the expected harvest. Aggregate cereal (maize, pearl millet, sorghum) production shows that, Namibia can expect a reduction in harvest of at least 53% of last season's harvest and over 42% below the average production. Table 1 below shows the cereal production statistics analysis in relations to 2018/2019 provisional crop estimates.

National Cereal Production Statistics Trend (in '000 metric Ton) and 2018/2019 provisional forecast production compared with a 20 - year average and 2017/2018 Production												
	2010/11	**2011/12**	**2012/13**	**2013/14**	**2014/15**	**2015/16**	**2016/17**	**2017/18**	**2018/19**	**20-year average**	**2018/19 as % of average**	**2018/19 as % of 2017/18**
Maize (Communal)	5.2	4.6	2.5	5.2	1.4	1.2	6.3	6.9	1.4	6.6	-78	-79
Maize (Commercial)	48.0	63.2	72.4	71.3	38.9	42.4	64.8	52.4	44.3	42.4	5	-15
Pearl Millet	41.1	55.9	24.7	44.1	15.3	19.4	57.6	83.5	18.7	57.5	-68	-78
Sorghum	5.8	7.7	2.2	4.1	1.7	1.5	2.8	4.0	1.0	7.1	-86	-75
Wheat	11.5	11.9	14.8	11.3	11.6	9.8	6.1	6.1	6.1	9.2	-34	0
Aggregate	**111.6**	**143.4**	**116.6**	**136.1**	**68.9**	**74.4**	**137.6**	**152.9**	**71.5**	**122.8**	**-42**	**-53**

Table 1: National cereal production statistics and 2018/2019preliminary forecast production compared to 2017/2018 harvest and a 20– year average production

As shown in Table 1, maize production forecast in the communal area (Zambezi, Kavango East and Kavango West regions) indicated a considerable reduction of 79% of last season's harvest, and 78% below the average production. This reduction is largely attributed to the general poor rainfall performance, which is said to have dominated the 2018/2019-rainfall season and to some extent Fall Armyworms reported in the regions. Maize production in the commercial area has also showed a slight reduction in the expected harvest of about 15% of last season's harvest, but is still 5% above the average production. This reduction in said to be caused by poor rainfall performance experienced this season in the dry-land maize production areas.

Furthermore, pearl millet production has also showed a considerable reduction in the expected harvest of at least 78% of last season's harvest and 68% below the average production. This

reduction is also due to the general poor rainfall performance experienced this season. Sorghum production is said to be the hardest hit and losses of over 75% of last season's harvest and about 86% below the average production can be expected. Wheat is a winter crop and production thereof will start in winter (May/June). However, for the purpose of national aggregate and analysis, harvest estimates for the 2017/2018 were used to develop the 2018/2019 estimates.

FOOD SECURITY SITUATION

Household food security remained satisfactory in most regions of the country, due to the good harvest of the 2016/2017 and 2017/2018 cropping seasons. At the time of this report, majority of households are still dependent on their harvests for food access. The harvest is expected to sustain households till the next harvest in May 2019. Many of pearl millet and maize producers were able to sell their surplus grains to commercial millers and Agricultural Marketing and Trade Agency (AMTA) for the Strategic Reserve stock purposes.

However, pockets of food insecurity are also still being reported in various areas especially those that suffered poor agricultural production as a result of prolonged dry spells or floods during the 2017/2018 rainfall season. With the current poor rainfall performance being experienced in the country, the food security situation is expected to worsen in the drought affected areas as the drought conditions strengthen.

Following is a summary of areas where food insecurity is still being reported:
Kunene (Okanguati, Etanga, Sesfontein, Kamanjab and Khorixas west); Khomas (Khomas Hochland); Omaheke (Aminuis, Corridor 13); Erongo (Otjimbingwe, Spitzkoppe, Okombahe, Tubusis, Omatjete and Uis) //Kharas (Karasburg, Vaalgras, Koes and Warmbad); Hardap (Maltahohe, Hoachanas, Gibeon and Gochas); Otjozondjupa (Ovitoto, Okakarara).
In the Zambezi Region, the drought-affected areas included Linyanti and partly Katima Rural Constituencies; while Kabbe North, Kabbe South and partly Katima Rural Constituencies noted poor crop harvest due to flood conditions. Ncamangoro, Ncuncuni, Mankupi and Kapako Constituencies in the Kavango West Region were affected by dry spells experienced earlier in 2017/2018 the season. Crop production in these areas showed reduced harvest when compared to 2016/2017 cropping season. Table 2 below shows contents of the Government Strategic Food Reserve (Silos).

Location	Holding Capacity (MT)	Stock Level (MT)	Current Stock in %
Katima Mulilo	7,400	2014.26	27
Rundu	4,000	972.85	24
Omuthiya	4,000	0	0
Tsandi	3,000	0	0
Okongo	4500	2587.12	57
Total	**22,900**	**5574.23**	**24**

Table 2: Government Strategic Food Reserve levels as of 5th April 2019

Sources: AMTA

Table 2 above shows that the Government Strategic Food Reserves have some grains of which Katima Mulilo and Rundu Silos have Maize in stock followed by Okongo silo with pearl millet grains. It is important to note that purchasing of pearl millet grains is still ongoing and some of the grains could not be stocked in the silos since they were set aside to be milled for the drought relief food distribution purposes. The pearl millet grains that could not be stored amounts to 704 Metric Tons. These grains could not be stored in the silos because it had to be fumigated. In addition, AMTA is expecting to procure 40,000 Metric Tons of maize grains from the commercial farmers by May 2019.

The Office of the Prime Minister (OPM) has a total of 3,799 Metric Tons of maize grains with AMTA, already procured for milling. Furthermore, OPM has procured 343 Metric Tons of pearl millet grains from AMTA for distribution to drought affected households.

Meanwhile, government has announced the Comprehensive Drought Interventions aimed at providing reliefs to the drought affected communities countrywide. The drought relief measures will be effected as from April 2019 to March 2020 and include food assistance, water provisions, livestock marketing incentives, lease of grazing and transport, as well as fodder and licks subsidy for core herds. This programme was preceded by earlier food relief intervention which was implemented in Omaheke, Erongo, Kunene, Otjozondjupa, Hardap and //Karas regions as from November 2018 to March 2019.

NEWFIU will continue to monitor the situation as it unfolds and provide update information accordingly.

PASTURE, LIVESTOCK AND WATER SUPPLY SITUATION

Pasture, livestock and water supply situation

Grazing conditions continued to deteriorate in most parts of the country amidst poor and below average rainfall currently being experienced countrywide. In most areas, grazing is reported to vary between fair and very poor. The situation has been exacerbated by the delayed rainy season, erratic and sporadic rainfall patterns as well as frequent prolonged dry spells, which in all instances accompanied by high temperatures. The southern regions and the north-western parts of the country are the most affected areas where poor rainfall was also experienced last season. Poor rainfall did not only impacted negatively on grazing, but also crop production and water resources.

Grazing was reported to range between fair to poor in Zambezi, and some parts Kavango West and Kavango East regions region. However, in Kavango East and Kavango West regions, grazing has improved slightly and was rated to be poor in areas along the river and poor to fair in the inland. Water availability for livestock was noted to be satisfactory through the rivers in areas along the rivers and boreholes, ponds or swamps in the inland areas.

Poor grazing conditions were widely reported in the North Central regions (Omusati, Ohangwena, Oshana and Oshikoto). It was noted that, poor grazing is worsened by firstly delayed rainfall season, frequent dry spells and lack of rainfall currently being experienced. Many farmers in these regions are reportedly moving their livestock form one area to another in search for better grazing. In addition, water availability; particularly for livestock consumption was reported to be poor in most areas as most rain-fed water catchments have little or no water owing to poor rainfall.

Very poor to critical grazing conditions were reported in Omaheke and the southern regions as well as Kunene and Erongo region. The central part of the country (Khomas and Otjozondjupa region), grazing was reported to range from poor and very poor. In the Kunene region, grazing was reported to be in a very critical state, particularly the southern part (Khorixas area) as well as the northern part whereby cases of livestock mortalities due to malnutrition are said to be on the rise **(see table 3).** It was noted that grazing is poor in the central part of the region (Erwee area). The eastern part of the Kunene region (Outjo area) received better rainfall

compared to other places in the region and grazing was reported to range between fair and good.

In the Erongo region grazing was reported to be very critical in areas of Okombahe, Spitzkoppe, Tubusis, Utuseb, Otjimbigwe and Uis in Daures Constituency. However, Omaruru received few showers in February but did not bring significant improvement on grazing. Drought conditions are reportedly still strengthening in the Omaheke region with Aminuis, Epukiro, Kalahari Gobabis, Otjombinde and Otjinene constituencies being the most affected areas. Although the region received some showers during January and February, the quantity received was not adequate to improve the grazing status. In the //Karas region, the grazing condition in Karasburg communal area was reported to be in its ‘’most” critical stage. The riverbeds are the only source of grazing which are available for the livestock. This includes places like Wortel, Us, Grysholte and Ysterberge where dry material with not much grazing value is available. Warmbad area is also in a critical stage. The Karasburg commercial area, grazing is critical especially in the places where water is available. The shrubs in the Berseba area are slightly recovering with no sign of grazing improvement.

Grazing is also reported to be critical in Bethanie. However, the Aus area has been reported to have a good grass sprout due to good rainfall received during January and February. Very poor grazing conditions were reported in Aroab area for bulk grazers and fair for browsers as most shrubs have positively reacted to the little rains received late December 2018 and early January 2019. The Keetmanshoop commercial area has not received any rainfall and hence the grazing is also very poor with bare notable patches in most of the southern and western parts of Keetmanshoop. The grazing condition in Tses area is said to be very critical in all sub-wards namely Kalk plateau, Vaalgras and Blouwes. Some rainfalls were received in Vaalgras and Blouwes but were very sporadic hence only shrubs and bushes (browse) have reacted well. In Hardap region, grazing condition is reported to range between poor and very critical and the situation is the same throughout the region. Furthermore, over the past five (5) years farmers in Maltahohe have heavily reduced their livestock numbers as a result of drought and its adverse effects on livestock.

Livestock conditions and water supply situation

In the north-eastern regions (Zambezi, Kavango East and Kavango West), livestock body condition was reported to range between fair and good. Poor to good livestock body conditions were reported in most of the north central regions (Omusati, Ohangwena, Oshana and Oshikoto).

Poor livestock conditions were reported in the southern regions (//Kharas, Hardap and Omaheke), north central (Omusati, Ohangwena, Oshana and Oshikoto), and north western regions (Kunene and Erongo) with livestock mortalities as a result of malnutrition being reported. The situation is more critical in Aminuis in Omaheke region and Ovitoto, Okakarara and Otjituuo in Otjozondjupa region as well as most part of Erongo, Hardap, //Karas and Kunene. Livestock in Khomas region are reported to be in a fair and good body condition.
No major livestock disease outbreaks were reported at the time of this report. However, cases related to poor grazing and tick infestations were widely reported in the regions. For example, cases of abortion in small stock were reported since January 2019 in Kunene region as well as unprecedented outbreak of ticks. Moreover, cases of Black quarter, pasturella, heart water, lumpy skin, Orf and Papillomatosis were also reported in the Zambezi, Kavango East and Kavango West regions.

Water availability for livestock continue to be a problem in some parts of the country due to late and poor rainfall performance experienced since the beginning of the rainfall season. Most communal farmers in Erongo, Omaheke, Erongo and //Karas region are facing water scarcity as the boreholes are yielding low and some have dried up. The water situation in Hardap, Khomas and Kunene region is satisfactory as most boreholes still have water to sustain livestock.

Table 3 below shows preliminary livestock estimated mortalities due to drought as from October 2018 to March 2019.

Estimates of Livestock figures that died due to drought from October 2018 to April 2019						
Region	**State Veterinary District**	**Cattle**	**Goats**	**Sheep**	**Donkeys**	**Horses**
Erongo	**Omaruru**	**5845**	**3776**	**2129**	**246**	**102**
Otjozondjupa	Okahandja	1230	110	110	0	8

	Okakarara	2996	1606	964	18	21
	Otjiwarongo	510	50	100	0	0
	Total	**4736**	**1766**	**1174**	**18**	**29**
Khomas	**Windhoek**	**810**	**0**	**0**	**0**	**0**
Kunene South	Kamanjab	277	110	86	25	71
	Outjo	50	65	18	0	0
	Total	**327**	**175**	**104**	**25**	**71**
Omaheke	Gobabis	1692	1416	742	40	94
	Epukiro	500				
	Otjinene	300				
	Total	**2492**	**1416**	**742**	**40**	**94**
Hardap	**Mariental**	**20**				
Karas	Keetmanshoop	2135	13500	14 000		
	Karasburg	424	75	22		
	Total	**2559**	**13575**	**22**	**0**	**0**
Kavango West	**Nkurenkuru**	**25**		**9**		
Kavango East	**Rundu**					
Zambezi	**Katima-mulilo**					
Oshana	**Ondangwa**	**1340**	**407**	**0**	**87**	
Omusati	**Outapi**	**2298**	**800**		**9**	
Oshikoto	**Omuthiya**	**323**				
Ohangwena	**Eenhana**	**4046**	**657**	**26**	**18**	
Kunene North	**Opuwo**	**6055**	**2026**	**4032**	**75**	
Total		**30876**	**24598**	**8238**	**518**	**296**

Table 3 shows preliminary livestock estimates that died due to drought as from October 2018 to March 2019.

DAMS LEVELS

Figure 5 below shows a summary of the dams/ reservoirs levels in the country as at 08th April 2019. Figure 5 indicated that, most dams/ reservoirs levels are low due to less inflow received this season compared to the corresponding period last year. Nonetheless, Goreangab, Naute and Oanob Dams received highest amount with their level of full capacity of 100.2%, 94.9% and 51.8% of their holding capacity respectively.

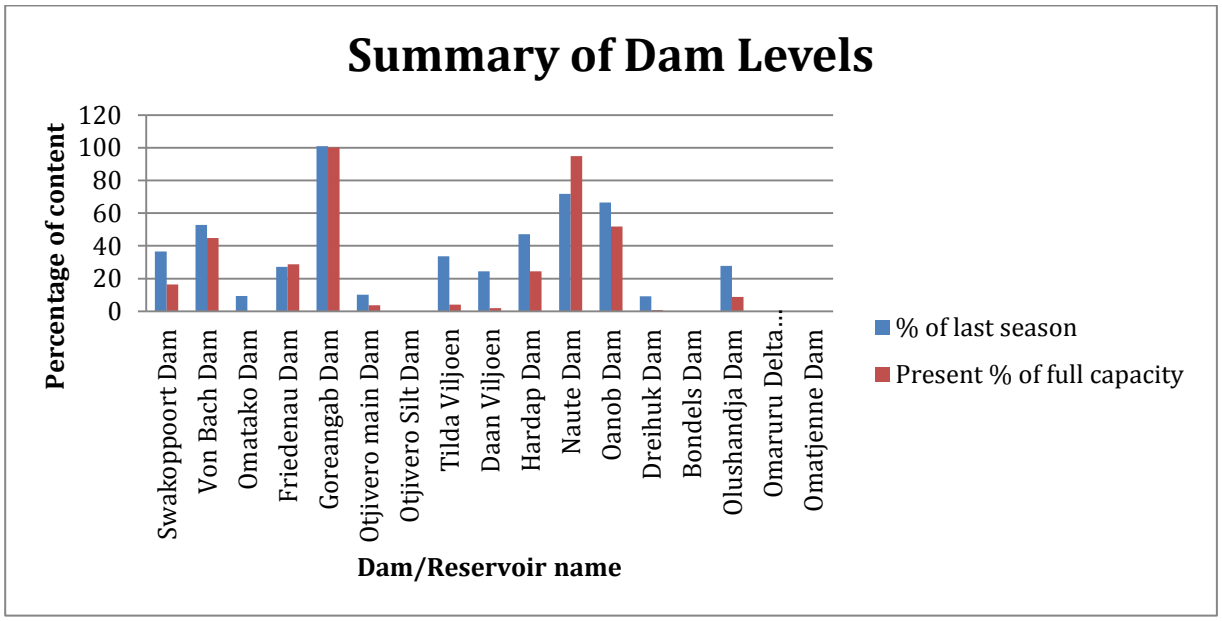


Figure 5: Summary of the Dam levels in the country as at 08th April 2019

Sources: Namibia Water Corporation Ltd

REGIONAL CROP AND FOOD SECURITY SITUATION

Zambezi region

The region is expecting poor agricultural production, following a poor and below average rainfall performance in 2018/2019 rainfall season. According to reports from the agricultural extension office, the region received its first rain toward end of October, but no follow up rainfall to back up the onset of the rainfall season resulting in the delay of cropping activities. Productive rainfall was reported to have received as from end of December, but rainfall performance was still poor. It was noted that, poor rainfall was seen in the forms of delayed rainy season, erratic and sporadic rainfall patterns with prolonged dry spells accompanied by high temperatures. It was further reported that water establishment in the water catchments were poor and not enough to sustain livestock for longer period especially for the inland areas. The agricultural inputs such as seeds and fertilizers were received on time and quantity was fairly sufficient for the season. The region received four tones of Pearl Millet seed from Mahenene Seed Growers. In addition, the region also had a carry-over stock of cowpea seed from the previous season, which was sold at a subsidised price of $35.00/2kg. A total of 2476 coupons of maize seeds were distributed to farmers, one coupon/farmer and one coupon is equivalent to10kg bag of maize seed. The region has 18 government tractors and a number of private tractors were also registered to render service to the farmers. Moreover, weeding groups were also registered and are active. Provisional estimates on aggregate cereals (maize, pearl millet, sorghum) showed a significant reduction in the expected harvest of about 76% lower than last season's harvest and about 77% below the average production. In this regards, maize production is estimated to drop by 80% lower than last season's harvest and 75% below the average production. Pearl millet production is said to have declined by 54% of last season and 84% below the average production. Sorghum production is also estimated to have suffered a reduction of 61% of last seasons' harvest and 76% below the average production. Moreover, harvest prospects for non-cereals were also reported to be poor owing to poor rainfall performance. The region reported incidences of fall armyworms damaging maize at on-station plots in Sangwali, Bukalo, Ngoma and Katima Agricultural Development Centres (ADCs) as well as in farmer's crop fields. However, crop damage is not severe and plans are underway to control pests by hosting demonstrations on pesticides application. Figure 6 below shows a summary of the provisional cereal harvest estimates.

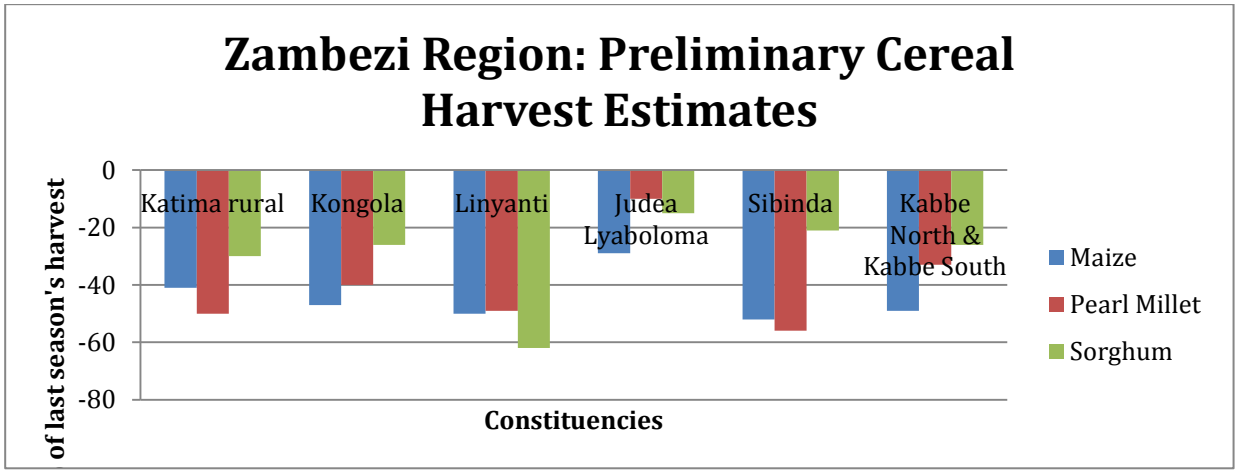


Figure 6: Summary of the preliminary cereal harvest estimates

Note: Harvest Estimates are highly conservative

Livestock and grazing were reported to range between fair and good conditions. No livestock disease outbreaks were reported at the time of this report. Water availability, particularly for livestock consumption was noted to be satisfactory in most areas either from the rivers, streams and boreholes. However, the water situation in the inland areas was reported to be fairly available as most water catchments have little water, which is expected to only last for a short period if no further rain is received. On household food security, it was reported that most households are dependent on the market for food access. Only few households have food from previous harvest, which is not likely to sustain them until the next harvest.

Constituencies

Katima Urban

Most part of this constituency is a town and residential area. With the exception of few home gardening and irrigation projects that exist in this area, no farming activities other than these are taking place. Hence it is irrelevant from the assessment team to report on the crop situation in this area.

Linyanti

Poor rainfall performance was widely reported in various parts of the constituency affecting the agricultural production as well as the water supply system. According to the report from the agricultural Extension officials responsible for this area, poor rainfall was seen in the forms of erratic and sporadic rainfall patterns with prolonged dry spells accompanied by high temperatures. This has resulted in reduced planted area, which is estimated at about 49% of the cropping area. Preliminary crop estimates indicated significant reduction in the expected harvest with maize production set to decrease by at least 50% and pearl millet is down by 49% of last season's harvest. Sorghum production was reported to have decreased by over 62% of last season's production. Moreover, harvest outlook for non-cereals was also said to be poor,

owing to ongoing drought conditions in the area. Six private tractor owners were registered to render service to farmers and only four has participated in this ploughing scheme. There were no draught animal service providers or weeding groups registered this year. Water availability in the area is limited because of poor rainfall especially in the inland where most of catchment areas have little water for livestock. There were no crop diseases reported in the areas. However, cases of Fall Army worms were reported in Kapani and Linyanti villages. The damage was however not significant.

The livestock body condition is reported to be good and so is the grazing. No major livestock diseases were reported at the time of this assessment. Household food security is reported to be satisfactory as most households still have food stock from their last harvest. However, the stock is not sufficient to sustain household until the next harvest, hence market purchases is used to prolong the availability of the harvest.

Judea Lyaboloma

In addition to a delayed rainy season, this area experienced frequent dry spells between November and December as well as January and February. Good rainfall showers were received late December and early January. Poor rainfall has causes crops to wilt and many farmers are reported to have replanted several times with little or no success. It was further reported that, poor rainfall has resulted in less water in water reservoirs for livestock compared to the previous season whereby the level of water in most of the swamps and reservoirs were full to capacity at the corresponding period last year. Many farmers are reported to have covered only about 47% of their crop fields. Preliminary cop estimates indicated a significant drop in the expected harvest with maize production set to decline by at least 29% and pearl millet is down by over 10% of last season's harvest. Sorghum production is estimated to have decreased by over 62% of last season's production. Moreover, harvest prospects for non-cereal crops are also said to be low due to ongoing drought condition in the area. Cases of Fall Army worms were reported at Lyashulu, Sangwali and surrounding areas however, damages to crops is said to be minimal. Farmers were advised to use traditional ways of controlling the worms such as hand picking, burn and burry the ashes.

Livestock and grazing were reported to be in a good condition. Cases of tick infestations and limping in cattle were reported in Lyashulu and Malengalenga communities. On the household food security, the situation is reportedly tightening as most households have depleted their last season's harvest and are now depended on the market for food access. Although farmers have harvested enough in the previous season, farmers have sold most of their grains to the millers. Very few households still have food from the previous harvest that can sustain them until the next harvest.

Kongola

No Agricultural Extension Technicians, hence no report for this area. However, average crop production estimates were used for this area to develop the crop estimates for regional analysis purposes.

Katima Rural

The area received below normal rainfall, which will have a negative effect on the expected harvest this season. The area noted a prolonged dry spell from

November extending to January. This has caused most of the crops to wilt especially those crops which were planted in December due to less moisture in the soil. Isolated cases of Fall Armyworms were reported in the area as well as cases of rats/mice destroying crops at germination causing farmers to replant several times with little or no success. The planted area is estimated at 58% of the cropping area. Preliminary crop estimates indicted a substantial reduction in the expected harvest with maize and pearl millet expected to drop by 41% and 50% of last season's harvest respectively. Moreover, sorghum production was also reported to have dropped by at least 30% of last season's production. Harvest prospects for non-cereals are also expected to yield low this season.

Livestock are reported to be fair but the situation is expected to deteriorate if no further rainfall is received for the remainder of the season. There is less water in the water catchment areas but not enough to sustain livestock for a longer period. With regard to household food security, it was reported that most households are still depending on their previous harvest although there are some who are depending on the market for food access.

Kabbe north and Kabbe south

Poor rainfall performance was widely reported in various parts of these constituencies. It was reported that poor rainfall was noted in the forms of erratic and sporadic patterns with prolonged dry spells accompanied by a high temperatures. Most of the water catchments for example earth dams and ponds are dry and only few had little water at the time of the assessment. Majority of farmers were able to cover about 33% of their crop fields. Preliminary crop estimates indicated substantial reductions in the expected harvest with maize set to decline by at least 49% and pearl millet is down by 33% of last season. Moreover, sorghum production was also reported to be low and a reduction of at least 26% lower than last season can be expected. No-cereal crops harvest is also expected to be lower than the previous season. On ploughing services, both government and private tractors and draught animal service providers were available to render ploughing services to the farmers. Inputs such as seed and fertilizer were also available on time though the quantity received this season is less compared to what was received last season. Cases of human-wildlife conflicts were reported where wild animals destroyed some crop fields.

Grazing was reported to be poor in the riverside area due to a large number of livestock but fair in the inland areas. This is because most farmers have moved their livestock to the riverside for better grazing. Livestock body condition was reported to range between fair and good. No major livestock diseases were reported at the time of this report. On the household food security, it was reported that most households are currently dependent on the market purchases for food access using money from peace work as well as Old age pension.

Sibbinda

As it was reported in other areas in the region, this constituency received late rainfall end of November as opposed to October last season. The rainfall received was also unevenly distributed. Famers in this area suffered prolonged dry spell in November and extended to January and February. However, good rainfall showers were received in February and this has filled up some ponds and other catchment areas. Planted area is estimated at 55% of the cropping area. Preliminary harvest estimates suggested massive reductions in the expected

harvest with maize production set to decrease by 52% and pearl millet is down by 56% of last season's harvest. Sorghum production is expected to decline by at least 21% of last season's harvest. Moreover, harvest prospects for non-cereals such as Bambara nuts and cowpeas are also expected to be low this season. Seed and fertilizer were available on time at the local ADC for easy access t farmers. Few cases of Fall Armyworms were reported in Kaliyangile and Masida areas.

Livestock were reported to be in poor condition due to poor grazing establishment in the area. However, the situation is expected to improve if good rainfall is received for the remainder of the season. No major livestock diseases were reported by the time of this assessment. Household food security was reported to have weakened as most farmers are said to have depleted their last season's harvest and now dependent on the market for food access. It was noted that, farmers sold most of their cereal grains to commercial millers in fear of damages by pests due to lack of proper storage at household level. Farmers are however using funds from the sales of their harvest to purchase food.

Kavango East and Kavango West regions

Poor agricultural production is expected, following insufficient and below average rainfall across the regions. The regions noted significant delay in the onset of the 2018/2019 rainfall season as well as frequent prolonged dry spells accompanied by high temperatures since the start of the rainy season in December last year. It was reported that, crops, which were planted with the first rains, have wilted and farmers have to replant several times with little or no success. This has resulted in drastic reductions in the expected harvest. Preliminary crop estimates indicated a massive reduction in the expected harvest with aggregate cereal set to decline by over 65% of last season's harvest and over 55% below the average production. In particular, pearl millet production has showed a reduction of at least 66% of last season and 48% below the average production. Maize production indicated a reduction of over 51% less than last season and about 85% below the average production. Sorghum production is down by 60% of last season and over 78% below the average production. Additionally, non-cereal production is also equally affected; hence poor harvest outlook thereof is anticipated. Average planted area is estimated at 55% of the cropping area, reflecting a reduction of about 18% when compared to the corresponding period last year. Seeds were available on time (Okashana, Kangara and Kantana, most of which was sourced from Likorerere Farmers Co-operative and few tons from Mahenene Seed Growers). The region reported shortages of basal dressing fertiliser (NPK & MAP) and only top dressing compounds were available in stock. Cases of Fall Armyworms were reports in Ndiyona and Ndonga linena in Kavango East as well as Kahenge and Ngone in Kavango West region. However, it was reported that the damage is very minimal. Figure 7a and Figure 7b show a summary of the crop harvest estimates in the Kavango West and Kavango East regions respectively.

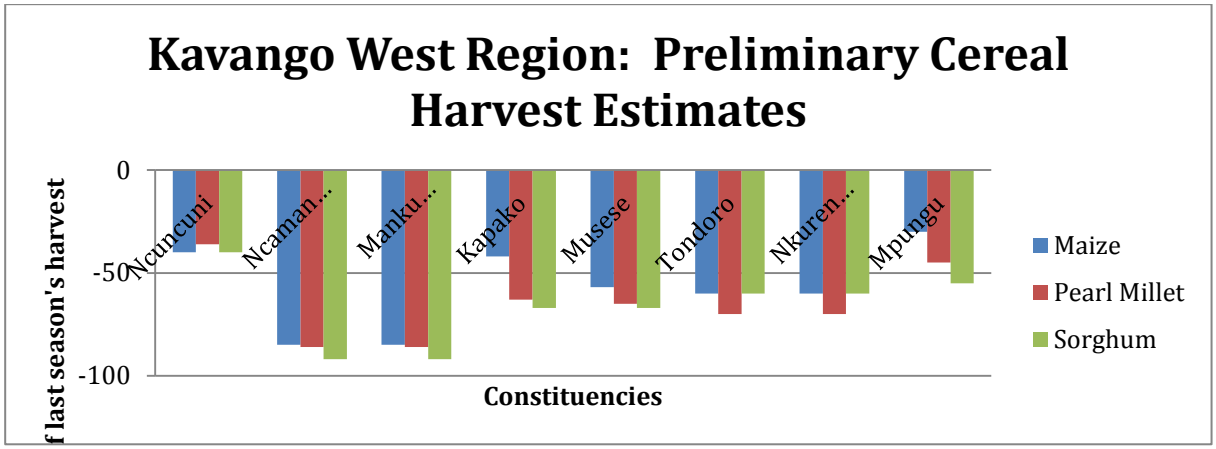


Figure 7a: Summary of the cereal harvest estimates in the Kavango West region

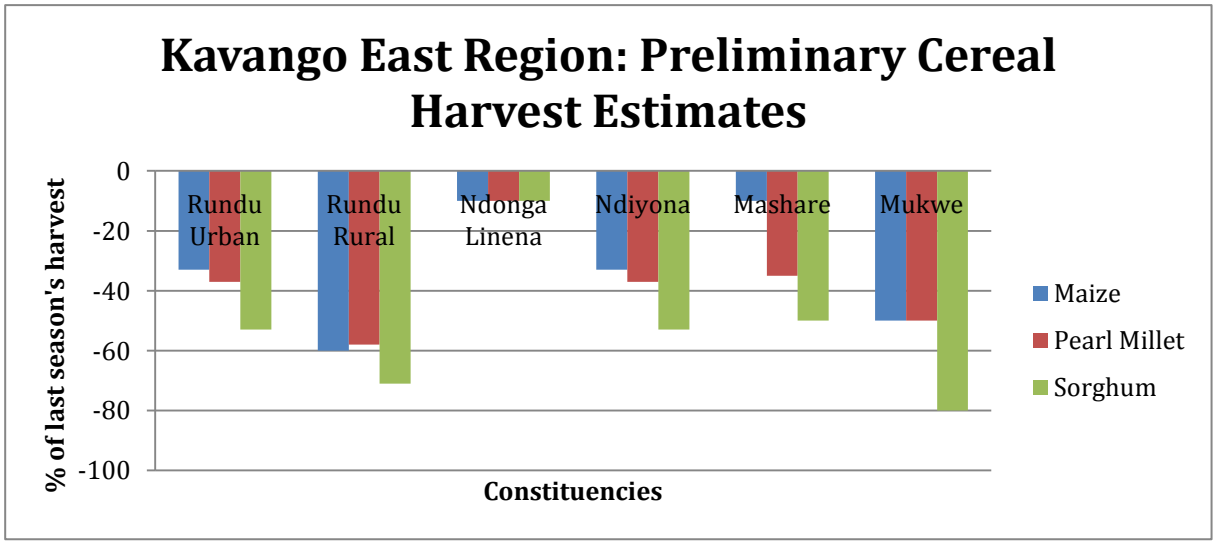


Figure 7b: Summary of the cereal harvest estimates in the Kavango East region

Note: Harvest Estimates are highly conservative

Cases of Botulism and internal parasites were widely reported in the regions. Grazing conditions were reported to range between poor and fair in the inland areas but poor in areas along the river. The regional Agricultural Extension Offices have advised farmers to sell some of their livestock in order to reduce the stocking rate and maintain few livestock to a rate that can be supported with available grazing. However, it was reported that with a challenge of formal markets in the regions, farmers are very hesitant to destock. On the household food security, majority of the households are reportedly still consuming from last year's harvest, which is estimated to last until April/May 2019. However, cases of households with difficulties in accessing food due to reduced harvest last season are still being reported in the regions.

Constituencies

Kavango West

Ncuncuni

Poor rainfall performance was reported in this area and as a result, poor agricultural production is expected this year. According to a report from the Agricultural Extension official responsible for this area, poor rainfall performance was seen in the forms of firstly delayed onset of the season, erratic and sporadic rainfall patterns as well as frequent prolonged dry spells accompanied by high temperatures. Under the circumstance, farmers were able to cultivate about 60% of their crop fields. It was reported that, seeds were available on time at the local ADC. Government tractors were also available to assist farmers but the demand is very high. It was further reported that there are still outstanding invoices for weeding groups and Draught Animal Power service providers who are not yet paid. This is said to have discouraged service providers to participate in the subsidy scheme this season. Preliminary crop harvest estimates showed significant reductions in the expected harvest with pearl millet production set to decline by 36% and both maize and sorghum are down each by 40% of last season's harvest. Additionally, harvest outlook for non-cereals is also said to be poor. No crop pests or diseases were reported at the time of this report.

Grazing was reported to range between fair and good with livestock body condition rated good state. However, due to poor rainfall as predicted this season, farmers are being advised to destock while early and not to wait for the situation to worsen.

Household food security was reported to have weakened as most households are said to have depleted their last year's harvest by December 2018. Many farmers are reportedly dependent on the market for food access.

Musese

As it was reported in other constituencies, farmers reported that, the 2017/2018 rainfall season as poor, when compared with the previous season. According to farmers, the rainfall started late and prolonged dry spells were experienced during December and January. Nevertheless, most farmers were able to finish their crop fields (100%) using tractors and or draught animals. Farmers indicated that they used seeds, which they retained from the previous season as well as subsidised seeds from their local agricultural office. Preliminary crop estimates showed that, both pearl millet and sorghum is expected to be below by 8% and 58% respectively. However, maize production showed an improvement of 39% of last season's harvest. Due to the destruction of wild animals, prospects for non cereal were reported to be poor when compared with the previous season.

No major crop pests or livestock diseases were reported at the time of this assessment. Livestock body condition and grazing were reported to be good. On household food security, the situation was reported to have weakened as most households are reported to have depleted their last season's harvest and now dependent on the market for food access. However, the situation is expected to improve as

from March, once the seasonal produce such as green maize, cowpeas, squashes, etc. become available and ready for consumption until the main harvest in May this year.

Ncamangoro and Mankumpi

Poor rainfall was reported in various parts of these constituencies. According to report from the Agricultural Extension official responsible for this area, poor rainfall was seen in the forms of first delayed onset of the rainy season, erratic rainfall patterns as well as frequent dry spells accompanied by high temperatures. Average planted area is estimated at 50% of the cropping area. Preliminary crop estimates indicated substantial reductions in the expected harvest with pearl millet production set to decrease by 86% and maize is down by 85% of last season's harvest. Sorghum production is said to be the hardest hit with an estimated losses of over 92% of last season's harvest. Moreover, harvest outlook for non-cereals was also reported to be poor due to below average and poor rainfall received in the area. It was also reported that, seeds were readily available at the ADC for farmers' easy access. However, there was no basal dressing fertilizer received this season.

Grazing condition was reported to be poor and this has resulted in poor livestock body condition. Even though farmers are encouraged to destock, there is currently no market for their livestock. No livestock diseases were reported at the time of this assessment. Households food security was reported to have weakened as most households are said to have depleted their last season's harvest and now dependent on the market for food access.

Kapako

As with other constituencies in the region, this area received low rainfall as compared to the previous season same time last year. Poor rainfall was seen in the forms of erratic and sporadic rainfall patterns with frequent prolonged dry spells accompanied by high temperatures. As a result, most farmers were only able to cover about 50% of their crop fields. Preliminary crop harvest estimates indicated a massive reduction in the expected harvest with pearl millet production set to decrease by over 42% and maize is down by at least 63% of last season's harvest. Sorghum production is said to be the harvest hit and losses of over 67% of last season's harvest can be expected. Furthermore, harvest outlook for non-cereal is said to be poor as much of the crops have wilted. Not crop pests or diseases were reported at the time of this report.

On the livestock's health, cases of internal parasites in goats were reported in the areas. The affected farmers were advised to de-worm and vaccinate their animals by their local Veterinary Office. Both grazing and livestock condition are reported to be in a fair state. Water is available at the river. On the household food security, the situation was reported to have weakened as majority of households are said to have depleted their food stock from the previous harvest and are currently depending on the market purchases for food access. Only few households are reported of having food from the previous harvest.

Mpungu

According to a report from the Agricultural Extension officials responsible for this constituency, the 2018/2019 rainfall started well on time, end of October last year, but have fallen short

of follow up rains to strengthen the onset of the rainfall season. It was noted that, productive rainfall was realised as from December, but even then, rainfall performance has been poor. The season is said to have characterised by frequent prolonged dry spells accompanied by high temperatures as well as erratic and sporadic rainfall patterns. Average planted area is estimated at 50% of the cropping area. Provisional crop estimates indicated substantial reductions in the expected harvest with pearl millet production set to decrease by 45% and maize is down by over 30% of last season's harvest. Sorghum production is expected to decrease by at least 55% of last season's harvest. Moreover, harvest outlook for non-cereals is also said to be poor this year. The Agricultural Extension officials noted that seeds were received on time and were fairly sufficient for the season. It was also noted that government tractors were readily available at the local ADCs for farmers' easy access. Isolated case of Fall Armyworms was reported in Mavhenge village with insignificant crop damage.

No major livestock diseases were reported at the time of this report. Grazing was reported to be good. The livestock body condition was noted to be good in areas along the river, but fair in the inland areas. On the household food security, the situation is reported to be satisfactory, following good harvest last season. Most households are still dependent on their last season's harvest for food access. Households noted that their harvest is expected to last till the next harvest.

Tondoro and Nkurenkuru

As it was reported in other constituencies in the region, the 2018/2019-rainfall season is very poor. Since the start of the season in, rainfall performance has been sporadic, erratic and unevenly distributed. It was reported that, the season is dominated by frequent prolonged dry spells accompanied by high temperatures. At the time of this report, farmers on average were able to cover up to 50% of their crop fields. Preliminary crop estimates indicated substantial reductions in the expected harvest with pearl millet production set to decrease by 70%, maize and sorghum are down each by 60% of last season's harvest. In addition, harvest prospects for non-cereals is also said to be poor. It was noted that seeds were received on time and the whole stock has been sold to farmers. However, due to multiple replanting farmers are still approaching the office for more seeds. The constituencies also reported that no top dressing fertilizers were received this season. Cases of Fall Armyworms were reported in Kahenge and Ngone villages but the damage was very minimal.

No livestock diseases were reported at the time of this report. On water availability, it was reported that most of the water catchment areas are dry as a result poor rainfall received so far. Grazing and livestock body condition was noted to be in fair state in areas along the river, but poor in the inland. The household food security was noted to be satisfactory as most households are reportedly still dependent on their harvests for food access. The harvest is expected to sustain the households till the next harvest in May 2019.

Kavango East

Rundu Urban

Poor rainfall was reported in this area and was associated with dry spells from the 2nd week of January to mid-February. Many farmers are said to have got discouraged and on average cultivated at most 50% of their crop fields. It was reported that, most water catchments are dry especially the inland areas. Nevertheless, it was noted that seeds were available on time, but no basal fertilizers available this season. Provisional crop estimates indicated significant reductions in the expected harvest with pearl millet production set to decrease by 58% and maize is down by 50% of last season's harvest. Sorghum production is also said to be poor and losses of over 71% of last season's harvest can be expected. Moreover, harvest outlook for non-cereals was also reported to remain the same as for last season.

Grazing and Livestock body condition was noted to be poor and the situation is expected to deteriorate if no further rainfall is received for the remainder of the season. Livestock farmers were advised to destock while their livestock are in a better state before the situation gets worse. On the household food security, the situation was reported to be okay as most households said to be dependent on their last year's harvest, which is likely to last until the next harvest.

Rundu Rural

As it was reported in other constituencies in the region, this area was not spared of the negative impacts of poor rainfall performance on agricultural production as well as on the water supply. Poor rainfall performance was seen in the forms of delayed onset of the rainy season, sporadic and erratic rainfall patterns with frequent and prolonged dry spells, accompanied by high temperature. Under the circumstances, majority of farmers were only able to cover up to 50% of their crop fields. Preliminary crop estimates, indicated a substantial reductions in the expected harvest with pearl millet set to decrease by over 58% and maize is down by at least 60% of last season's harvest. Sorghum production is estimated to decline by 71% of last season's harvest. Although seeds were available on time at the ADC, no fertilizers were received this season. There were reports of crop diseases or pests experienced in the area at the time this information was collected.

No major livestock diseases were reported at the time of this report. Grazing and livestock body condition, were reported to be in fair state. Farmers were advised to start selling some of their livestock in order to keep the sizable amount of livestock that is sustainable with the current grazing. On the household food security, the situation was reported to be satisfactory as most households are said to be dependent on their harvest, which is being supplemented with market purchases.

Mashare

According to the Agricultural Extension Official responsible for this area, the rainfall amount received for the 2018/2019-rainfall season is slightly higher when compared with same time last season. However, rainfall distribution was poorly distributed as some areas received better showers compared to others. The area was also affected by

dry spells from the beginning of the season. Little water is available in most swamps while some have already dried up. Seeds were available at the ADC on time but there was still more seed available by the time of the assessment. This is attributed to the fact most farmers' attained enough seed at a household level from last year's harvest. No fertilizer was received this season though the demand from farmers is high. Most farmers have managed to cover about 69% of their crop fields. Preliminary crop harvest outlook showed significant reductions in the expected harvest with maize production set to drop by at least 10% and pearl millet is down by 35% of last season's harvest. Sorghum production was reported to have been the hardest hit and losses of at least 50% of last season's harvest can be expected. In addition, harvest outlook for non-cereals is also expected to be poor. No crop pests or diseases were reported at the time of this report.

On livestock health, no livestock diseases were reported at the time of this assessment. Livestock and grazing were noted to be in fair condition throughout the area. The Agricultural Extension officials have advised farmers to destock in order to reduce pressure on the available grazing. Household food security was reported to have weakened as most households are reported to have depleted their last season's harvest and is now dependent on the market for food access.

Mukwe

The 2018/2019 rainfall season is said to have started very late with uneven rainfall distribution. Dry spells were also experienced from the onset of the season during October and November. Crop estimates indicated a reduction in the expected harvest with maize and pearl millet both expected to drop by 50% while sorghum is expected to decrease by 53% of last season's harvest. Most farmers in the area have managed to cover up to 50% of their crop field at the time of the assessment. Due to erratic and sporadic rainfall received in the area, non-cereal crops are also expected to yield low this season as opposed to the previous season. Production inputs such as seeds were available on time at the local ADC for farmers' easy access. However, fertilisers were still not available because they were not yet received in the region.

No major livestock diseases were reported at the time of this report. Grazing and livestock body conditions were reported to be fair. Household food security was reported to have weakened as only few households are reportedly still having food stock from the previous harvest, but supplementing with market purchases to prolong the harvest.

Ndiyona

This area received poor rainfall this season as compared to the previous season, with dry spells mostly noted since December till February. Planted area is estimated at 80% of the cropping area, which is about 12% higher than the same period last season. Preliminary crop estimates showed a significant reduction in the expected harvest with maize production set to decline by 33% and pearl millet production is down by over 37% of last season. Sorghum production is also down and a reduction of over 53% of last season's harvest can be expected. Additionally, harvest outlook for non-cereals is also reported to be poor, owing to poor rainfall performance, which is said to have dominated the season. Few incidences of Fall Armyworms were reported in the area, but damages

to crop is said to be minimal. To avoid further damages by pests, farmers were however advised to use traditional ways to control the pests.

No major livestock diseases reported at the time of the assessment. Water for livestock stock was noted to be satisfactory with river and boreholes being the sources. Livestock body condition as well as grazing is reported to be in good state. On the household food security, the situation was reported to be weakening as most households are reported to have depleted their last year' harvest and currently depending on market purchases for food access. However, few households still have food stock from last year's harvest, which is expected to last till May 2019.

Ndonga Linena

The 2018/2019-rainfall season was reported to be poor with rainfall characterised by erratic and sporadic patters with frequent prolonged dry spells and high temperatures. It was reported that, most water catchments have little water. Nevertheless, seeds were available on time and all were sold out. However, there were no fertilizers received this season and farmers have been approaching the local Agricultural Development Centre for fertilizer. Average planted area is estimated at 70%, which is 5% less than the same time last season. Government tractor continued to be in high demand and at the time of the assessment, about 133ha was ploughed while 13ha were ripped. Preliminary crop estimates indicated a substantial reduction in the expected harvest with both maize, pearl millet and sorghum expected to drop by over 10% of last season's harvest. Cases of Fall Army worms were reported early February at Shikenge village but the damage was reported to be very minimal.

No livestock diseases were reported at the time of the assessment. Livestock and grazing condition were reported to range between fair and good. Household food security was noted to be satisfactory as most households are still consuming from their previous harvest. However, according to households, their harvest is likely to sustain them till end of March.

Omusati

The region is expecting poor agricultural production, following extremely poor rainfall performance which is said to have dominated the season. It was reported that, since the start of the 2018/2019 rainfall season in October last year, rainfall performance has been very poor and characterised by delayed onset of the rainfall season, sporadic and erratic rainfall patterns with frequent prolonged dry spells coupled with extremely high temperatures. As a result, crop and livestock production as well as the water supply are affected. Most farmers have already given up hope on the possibility of good harvest while some did not even cultivate at all. Preliminary crop estimates indicated a massive reduction in the expected harvest with aggregate cereals set to decline by 84% of last season's harvest and about 78% below the average production. In this regard, pearl millet production is expected to decrease by 85% of last season's harvest and 78% below the average production. Sorghum production is estimated to decline by 75% of last season's harvest and about 92% below the average production. Furthermore, it was noted that, there will be very little to no harvest for non-cereals in the region this season. At the time of compiling this report many farmers are reported to have covered only about 42% of their crop fields, which suggest a reduction of 42% when compared with the same time last season. Nonetheless, agricultural inputs and services were timely available at the ADCs for farmers' easy access. However the demand for seed was very high compared to the quantity supplied. It was reported that the region did not receive fertilizers this season. No crop pests or diseases were reported at the time of this report. Figure 8 below showed the summary of the preliminary crop estimates in various parts of the region.

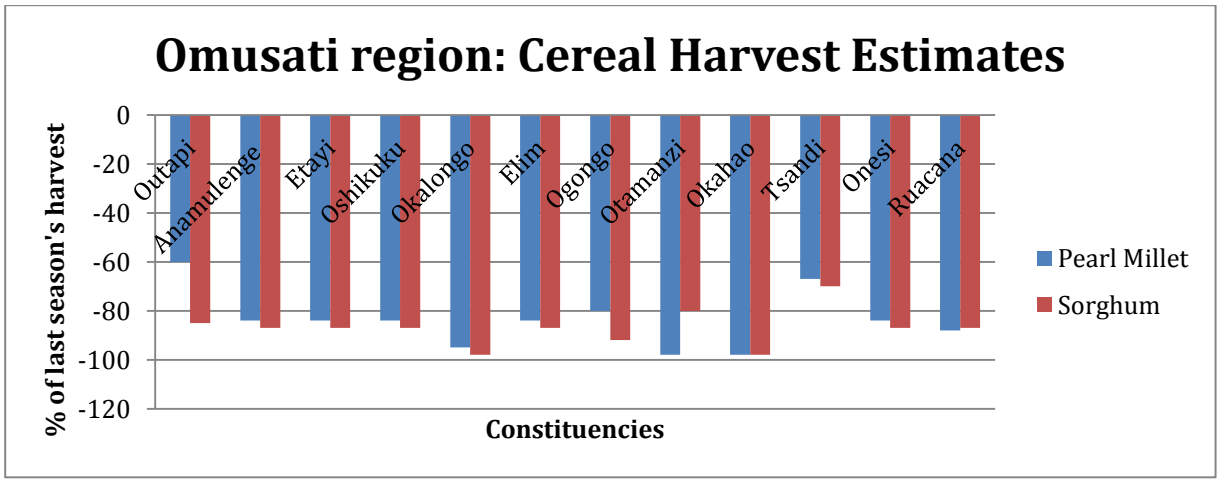


Figure 8: Summary of the preliminary cereal harvest estimates

Note: Harvest Estimates are highly conservative

Grazing was reported to range between poor to very poor with poor scoring for livestock body condition. As a result, a number of livestock mortalities were reported in various constituencies owing to very poor grazing. Water for livestock was also reported to be a challenge as most of the water catchment areas have dried up. Although farmers were advised to destock while the livestock are in reasonable fair condition, many farmers are reluctant to destock due to lack of formal market in the region. On the household food security, the situation was noted to be satisfactory as most households are still dependent on their last season's harvest for food access. However, the situation is expected to weaken as from harvest (May 2019) due to very poor agricultural production expected this season.

Constituencies

Onesi

The current season's rainfall was reported to be poor, as compared to the previous season. According to farmers, frequent dry spells were experienced during December and January. At the time of this assessment, most farmers were able to cover 82% of their crop fields. Preliminary crop estimates indicated significant reductions in the expected harvest with pearl millet set to decrease by 36% and sorghum is down by 58% of the last season's harvest. Harvest prospects for non cereal crops were reported to be very poor when compared with previous season. It was reported that, most farmers use seeds retained from the previous season and supplemented with subsidized seeds. Crop pests reported included fall armyworms at Elondo C and surrounding villages but damages to crops is minimal.

No livestock diseases were reported at the time of this assessment. Livestock body condition was reported to ranging between fair and poor, but recovering slowly. Grazing was reported to be poor with its recovery affected by poor rainfall. On household food security, the situation was reported to be satisfactory as most households are reported to still feeding from last season's harvest.

Ruacana

The rainfall received so far in the constituency is very poor compared to the same time in the previous season. There is no water in the catchment reservoirs mainly for livestock. Dry spells and high temperatures resulted in the wilting of crops and there is less hope for good harvest this season. Most farmers did not cultivate at all and those who cultivated only covered about 42% of their crop fields, which is half of last season's area planted. Preliminary crop estimates indicated a massive reduction in the expected harvest with both pearl millet and sorghum production estimated to decrease by 88% and 87% of last season's harvest respectively. There is no expected harvest for non cereal crops this season due to very poor rainfall.
There were no reports of pests and crop diseases at the time of data collection.

Both grazing and livestock body condition is very poor and livestock mortalities have been reported. The household food security was noted to be satisfactory as many households are reportedly still dependent on their last season's harvest for food access. However, the situation is expected to weaken as from May 2019 amidst the poor agricultural production expected this season.

Tsandi

The current rainfall season is very poor and the rainfall distribution was not evenly distributed. This poor rainfall is also accompanied by prolonged dry spells and high temperatures since the onset of the season. This has resulted in the wilting of crops and there is no hope for harvest this season. The agricultural inputs and services were readily available at the ADC well on time but the supply was low as the demand was very high. There was no fertilizer received this season although the demand is also high. Average planted area is estimated at 40%, which is 33% lower than the area planted same time last season. Preliminary crop estimates indicated a massive reduction in the expected harvest with pearl millet and sorghum expected to reduce by 67% and 70% of last season's harvest respectively. The non cereal crops are expected to yield very low this season if not zero harvest. No crop pests and diseases were reported at the time of this report.

Grazing was reported to be extremely poor in the entire constituency and livestock body condition is also very poor. A number of livestock mortalities were reported and the situation is worsening day by day. If no rain is received for the reminder of the season to improve the pasture, more livestock mortalities will be on the rise. With regard to household food security, the situation is currently satisfactory as most households still depending on the previous harvest stock. However, this stock will not last for long as it can only sustain households up to April and May 2019.

Outapi

The rainfall received this season is very poor compared to the previous rainfall season. Crops have wilted due to prolonged dry spells and extreme high temperatures. The earth dams and other rainfall catchment areas have no water at the moment and the only source of water for livestock is the canal. Given the current situation, the planted area is estimated at 40%, which is 44% lower than the area planted same period last season. The reduction in the areas planted is mostly as a result of poor rainfall received so far as farmers were unable to finish their crop fields due to less moisture in the soil. Preliminary crop estimated indicated a drastic reduction in the expected harvest with pearl millet and sorghum are both expected to decrease by 60% and 85% of the previous season's harvest respectively. The seed was received well on time at the constituency ADC but the demand was too high. Farmers kept flocking to the ADC in search for more seed due to several replanting as a result of poor germination. No fertilizer was received this season, though the demand is also high. The government tractor only managed to plough about 200ha up to date. Private tractors and weeding groups as well as draught animal service providers were also registered to partake I n the ploughing and subsidy weeding schemes. However, due to poor rainfall received this season they did not do much. No crop pests and diseases were reported.

The grazing is very poor resulting in very poor livestock body condition. Farmers are currently buying fodder for their livestock (those who can afford) but most of the farmers are still waiting for rain to improve at least the grazing for their livestock. There is a fear that if no rainfall is received for the reminder of the season, many livestock will die. Most households indicated that they are still consuming from last year's harvest which is likely to last until end of April. Therefore, the household food security situation is likely to worsen as from May because no crop harvest is expected.

Etayi

Due to technical difficulties beyond our control, we were unable to obtain information from this constituency, hence no report.

Okalongo

Like other areas in the constituency, rainfall received in this area is very poor compared to the previous rainfall season and the distribution was also not even for the most of the constituency. Severe dry spells were experienced from November extending to early January as a result, crops wilted. The wilting of crops was also exacerbated by extremely high temperatures. Nevertheless, farmers managed to plant about 50% of their crop fields, which is 49% lower than the planted area same time last year. With regard to crop harvest prospects, it is estimated that pearl millet will decrease by 95% and sorghum expected to drop by 98% of last season's harvest. The non cereal crops are also expected to yield very poor this season as most farmers did not even attempt to plant non cereals this year. The inputs such as seed were received on time but however the demand was very high and the consignment received was very less compared to what was received last season. The demand for fertilizer was also very high unfortunately no fertilizer was received this season. The government tractor only managed to plough about 70 ha this season due to insufficient rainfall and breaking down of tractors.

No cases of crop pests or diseases reported at the time of this assessment. However, pulpy kidney was reported mostly in goats. Grazing is very poor in the constituency hence poor livestock body condition. On the household food security, the situation is satisfactory but expected to worsen after May 2019 as farmers are expecting very poor harvest this season.

Anamulenge

Like other constituencies in the region, this area has also suffered poor rainfall performance since the beginning of the 2018/2019 rainfall season. Poor rainfall was seen in the forms of erratic with frequent dry spells experienced throughout the season. Few rainfall showers were received in January and February but were still poor to improve the crop germination and the late planted crops. It was noted that inputs and services arrived early but seeds were not sufficient. In addition, the constituency did not receive fertilizer this season and farmers kept enquiring about the availability of the fertilizer and the ADC. Average planted area is estimated at about 42% of the cropping area. However, there are a number of farmers who did not cultivate at all and have given up due to poor rainfall. Provisional crop estimates indicated a substantial reduction in the expected harvest with pearl millet and sorghum production expected to decrease by over 84% and 87% of last season's harvest respectively. Furthermore, harvest outlook

for non-cereals is also said to be poor this year due to poor rainfall received. No crop pests or diseases were reported at the time of this report.

Grazing and livestock body condition were reported to be very poor and cases of livestock mortalities were reported. Livestock especially cattle are lean and some are unable to stand on their own. No livestock diseases were reported at the time of this report. Majority of households are still having food from the previous harvest following the good harvest last season. However, their food stock is only sufficient till end of July and August 2019.

Ogongo

Rainfall performance this very poor and worse compared to that of last season. There is no water in the rain fed reservoirs and the only source of water for livestock is the canal. Provisional crop harvest estimates shows drastic reduction in the expected crop harvest with pearl millet expected to decrease by 80% while sorghum expected to reduce by 92% of the previous harvest. There will be no harvest for non cereals this season because nothing was planted. Many farmers did not even cultivate at all owing to poor rainfall received so far and those who managed to cultivate only covered about 30% of their crop fields, a 63% less than the area planted same period last season. The inputs and services were available at the ADC but the demand was too high, most farmers could not acquire the seed. Although the demand for fertilizer is also high, there were no fertilizers received this season. On the ploughing services, the GRN tractor only ploughed 65ha to this date. No crop pest and livestock diseases were reported.

The current livestock condition is extremely poor and animals are very lean due to the lack of grazing in the constituency. The situation is expected to worsen if no rainfall will be received for the reminder of the season to improve the pasture. Famers are more worried about their livestock as a result of this prevailing drought. The household food security situation is said to be fine as most households are said to be dependent on their last season's harvest for food access. However, the situation is expected to weaken at harvest amidst the poor agricultural production expected this year.

Okahao

This area received very poor rainfall this season and the first rainfall was received in the 2nd week of January. This has delayed cultivation activities and as a result majority of farmers were able to cover roundabout 42% of their crop field. Some areas in the constituency such as Onambadje, Okolumono, Akutsima and Nakatili did not receive any rain to date and as a result, farmers did not cultivate. The rain fed water reservoirs are completely dry and water for livestock is currently a very big challenge. Preliminary crop estimates indicated a drastic reduction in the expected harvest of about 98% below last year's harvest for both pearl millet and sorghum. The non cereal crops such as cow peas, bambara nuts, squash and melons expects extremely poor harvest if nothing at all. Although the Agricultural inputs were provided on time though in less quantity as compared to the previous season, this did not make much difference as no sufficient rainfall was received. However, government tractor managed only to plough about 108ha in total. No crop pests and diseases were reported at the time of this assessment.

Ticks were reported to be the main problem on livestock, mostly cattle. Grazing is very poor both in the inland and cattle post area and this has

resulted in very poor livestock body condition. A number of livestock mortalities were reported due to the prevailing drought condition. Most households have already depleted their last year's harvest and the situation is expected to worsen as from May 2019 because no harvest is expected this season.

Otamanzi

Poor rainfall was received in this constituency since the beginning of the season. The rainfall received was very sporadic and erratic with dry spells experienced for the most of the season accompanied by high temperatures. Even though the rainfall received up to date is very low, farmers have managed to cultivate about 51% of their crops while there are still a number of farmers who did not cultivate at all owing to poor rainfall performance. Preliminary crop estimates indicated a massive reduction on the expected harvest where pearl millet and sorghum production are expected to decrease by 98% and 80% of last season's harvest respectively.

On livestock health, no diseases were reported apart from conditions related to drought. Grazing is very poor throughout the area and livestock body condition is extremely poor. Household food security is currently satisfactory as most households are still relying on their previous harvest for food success. However, the current stock will be depleted around June/July 2019 and households will then rely on the markets and relief food onwards.

Elim

Poor rainfall performance was widely reported in this area. Prolonged and severe dry spells dominated the first half of the season extending to the 2nd half of the rainfall season. Crops which managed to germinate have wilted as a result of poor rainfall received as well as high temperatures. Preliminary crop harvest estimates indicated a substantial reduction in the expected harvest with pearl millet and sorghum production set to decrease by at least 84% and 87% of last season's harvest respectively. The non cereal crops are also expected to yield very low this season as most farmers did not plant non cereal crops due to poor rainfall. Nevertheless, farmers who have cultivated only covered about 42% of the crop fields, 52% lower than the area planted same period last year.

There were no reports of crop pests and livestock diseases. However, livestock body condition and grazing is currently in a very critical stage and many cattle are reported to be very week and unable to stand on their own. Cases of livestock mortalities have been reported in this area and the number of mortalities is increasing on a daily basis. Due to good harvest of last season, most households are still depending on the previous harvest stock. However, this stock will only last for few months and is likely to deplete by June/July 2019. Households will then need assistance onwards.

Oshikuku

No Agricultural Extension Technician in this constituency, hence no report.

Oshana region

Poor agricultural production is expected amidst ongoing drought conditions in the region. Poor rainfall performance accompanied by frequent prolonged dry spells and high temperature are reported to have dominated the 2018/2019-rainfall season and as a result, very poor agricultural production is expected. Poor crop germinations were reported in the region and due to frequent prolonged dry spells and high temperature, much of the crops have since wilted. Average planted area is estimated at 68% of the cropping area, reflecting a reduction of about 25% when compared to the same time last season. Aggregate cereal estimates indicated a negative outlook in the expected harvest of 86% lower than last season's harvest and 75% below the average production. In particular, pearl millet production is estimated to decrease by over 86% of last season's production and 74% below the average production. Sorghum production is expecting a reduction of 83% over last season's harvest and about 88% below the average production. In addition, harvest outlook for non-cereals, such as cowpeas, squash and melons was also noted to be poor, following poor germination and wilting due to poor rainfall. Figure 9 below shows the summary of cereal harvest estimates in various parts of the region.

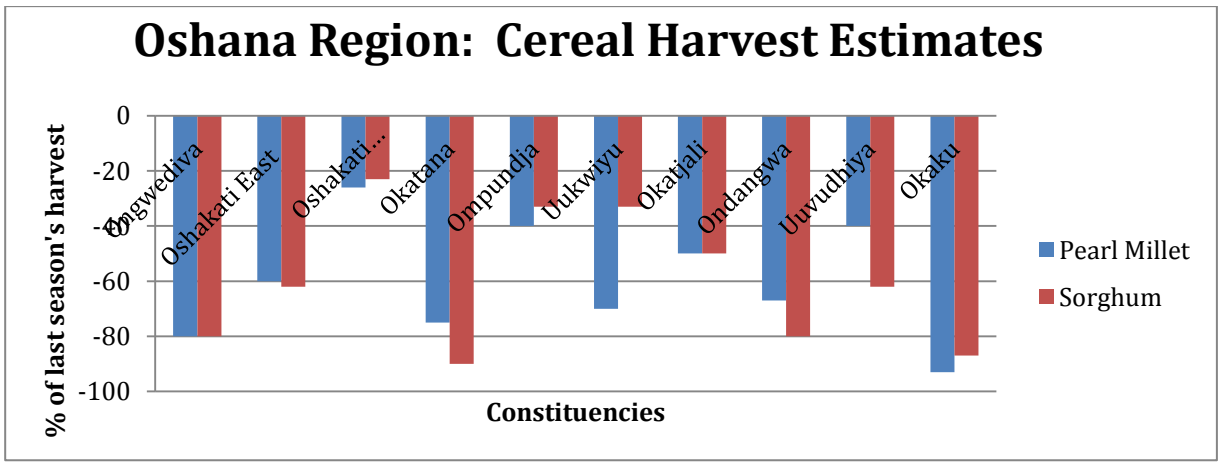


Figure9: Summary of the cereal harvest estimates

Note: Harvest Estimates are highly conservative

Poor grazing conditions were widely reported, especially the inland part of the region. Livestock body condition is reported to range between fair and poor in the inland, but fair to good in the cattle post areas. Water availability especially for livestock was also reported to be

a challenge as most water catchment areas are dry and only few with little water. No major livestock diseases were reported at the time of the assessment. The household food security remained satisfactory, as most households are reportedly still dependent on their last season's harvest for food access. However, food security situation is expected to weaken as from harvest time (May 2019) due to poor agricultural production expected this season.

Constituencies

Ongwediva

Poor rainfall continues to dominate the 2018/2019-rainfall season and as a result, farmers are expecting poor agricultural production this year. According to a report from the agricultural extension in this constituency, rainfall patterns have been poor since the start of the season in October last year. At the time of the assessment, majority of farmers were reported to have covered about 60% of their crop fields. Although, improved seeds were available at the ADC on time, the quantity was not enough due to poor germination and farmers have to replant several times with little or no success. Provisional crop estimates for this area indicated significant reductions in the expected harvest with pearl millet and sorghum estimated to decrease by 80% each of last season's harvest.

No major livestock diseases were reported at the time of this assessment. Grazing was reported to be poor with livestock body condition ranging between fair and poor. Household food security was noted to be satisfactory as most households are still dependent on their own production, following a good harvest last year. However, the situation is expected to deteriorate during the course of the current season amidst the expected poor harvest.

Okatana

This area noted late start of the rainfall season as productive rainfall were only realised as from end of November instead of early November. It was reported that, overall rainfall performance is very poor this season. The season is said to have characterised by erratic and sporadic rainfall patterns with high temperature. It was noted that most water catchment areas are dry and crops are wilting because of insufficient moisture in the soil. Average planted area is estimated at 95% of cropping area. However, crop germination is said to be very poor and many farmers have attempted to replant several times with little or no success. Preliminary crop estimates indicate a sharp decrease in the expected harvest with pearl millet expected to decrease by 75% and sorghum is down over 90% of last season's harvest. Seeds were reported to have come on time but were not enough due to poor germinations and that farmers have to replant several times with limited success. No fertilizers stock was received this season. Although nine tractors were registered to participate in the government ploughing subsidy services, only three tractors participated rendered the ploughing services.

Grazing was reported to be poor with livestock body condition said to be ranging between poor and fair. Water supply for livestock was said to be poor as most water catchments are dry. The household food security was reported to be satisfactory as most farmers are still relying on their previous year food access. However, the situation is expected to

deteriorate since farmers are expecting a very poor agricultural production this year.

Oshakati West

As it was noted in other constituencies in the region, the 2018/2019-rainfall season has been poor since it started in October last year. The season is characterised by sporadic and erratic rainfall patterns compounded with frequent prolonged dry spells and extremely high temperatures. Average planted area was estimated at 70% of the cropping area and farmers are still waiting for the rainfall for them to proceed with cultivations. Preliminary crop estimates showed a negative outlook with pearl millet and sorghum production forecasted at 26% and 23% lower than the last season's harvest respectively. Moreover, harvest outlook for non-cereal crops is also said to be poor and lower than last season because of ongoing poor rainfall conditions.

No major livestock diseases were reported at the time of the assessment. Livestock are reported to be in a fair to poor condition. Grazing was reported to be poor and the situation is expected to deteriorate if no further rainfall is received soon. Household food security situation was noted to be satisfactory as most households are said to still dependent on last season's harvest for food access. However, the situation is expected to deteriorate amidst the expected poor agricultural production.

Uuvudhiya

Farmers are expecting a poor harvest this season, due to poor rainfall performance, which is said to have dominated the season. It was reported that rainfall started on time in October last year, but there were no follow up rainfall to strengthen the onset of the rainy season. Crop germination is said to be poor due to poor rainfall and farmers have to replant several times with limited or no success. At the time of the report, majority of farmers are reported to have covered about 60% of their crop fields. No fertilizers stock was received this season. Preliminary crop estimates indicated a negative outlook in the expected crop harvest with pearl millet estimated to decrease by 40% of last season's harvest. Harvest outlook for non-cereals was also reported to be poor due to ongoing drought conditions in the region.

No livestock diseases were reported at the time of this report. Livestock body condition is reported to range between fair and good in the cattle post area and poor to fair elsewhere. The household food security was noted to be fine as most households are reported to still dependent on last season's harvest for food access. However, due to poor expected agricultural production this year many households are likely to face food insecurity this year.

Oshakati East

As it was reported in other constituencies in the region, the 2018/2019 rainfall season has been poor sand is characterised by erratic and sporadic rainfall patterns with prolonged dry spells accompanied by high temperatures. As a result, agricultural production is negatively affected. Although, seeds came on time at the ADC, the quantity was not enough due to poor crop germinations and that farmers replanted many times with limited or no success. Average planted area is estimated at 60% of the cropping area. According to a report from the agricultural extension officials responsible for this area, farmers suffered a complete crop failure, as there will be no harvest this season. Cases of False

Armyworms were reported at Iikuku and Oshipumbu villages, but damages to crops is said to be minimal.

Cases of infectious Coryza involving chickens were reported at Iikuku village and about 10 chickens are reported to have died from this disease. Grazing was reported to be poor due to ongoing drought conditions. Livestock body condition was reported to range between poor and fair. With regards to household food security, the situation is said to be satisfactory as most households are still dependent on their last season's harvest for food access. However, the situation is expected to deteriorate due to poor agricultural production expected this year.

Ompundja

Despite the good start of the 2018/2019 rainy seasons in October last year, rainfall performance continued to deteriorate in the area. According to a report from the Agricultural Extension office for this area, poor rainfall performance was widely reported in this area resulting in poor agricultural production expected this year. It was reported that, poor rainfall was seen in the forms of erratic and sporadic rainfall patterns with frequent prolonged dry spells, accompanied by high temperatures. At the time of the assessment, most farmers are reported to have covered about 95 % of the crop field. However, Villages such as Ombonde, Iilunga-Yeepa, Mulunga and Onathinge many farmers ploughed when it was completely dry, as the rainfall distribution has been coming in small quantities. Provisional crop estimates indicated a substantial reduction in the expected harvest with pearl millet set to decrease by 40% and sorghum is down by 33% of last seasons' harvest. Furthermore, harvest prospects for non-cereals is also said to be poor due the ongoing drought conditions in the area.

No major livestock diseases are reported at the time of this assessment. Livestock body condition was reported to range between fair and poor. On the household food security, the situation was reported to be satisfactory as most households are said to still dependent on their last season's harvest for food access. However, the situation is expected to deteriorate amidst the expected poor agricultural production in the area.

Ondangwa Urban and Rural

Poor rainfall conditions were widely reported in the constituency resulting in delayed cultivation and poor agricultural production this season. According to a report from the Agricultural Extension office for this area, poor rainfall was seen in the forms of erratic and sporadic rainfall patterns with frequent prolonged dry spells, accompanied by high temperatures. It was reported that majority of farmers cultivated about 50% of their crop fields. The area is dry and drought conditions are visible in the constituency. Provisional crop estimates showed a significant reduction in the expected harvest with pearl millet production is estimated to decrease by 67% and sorghum is down by 80% of last season's harvest. In addition, harvest outlook for non-cereals is also said to be poor due to the prevailing drought condition in the area. Cases of False Armyworms were reported in the area, but the damage to crop is not yet severe.

Grazing condition was reported to be poor and continue to deteriorate due to drought conditions. Many farmers are reported to have moved their livestock to other constituencies for better grazing. Some farmers are reported to have lost some of

their livestock (mainly ewes) do drought condition. Ticks infestation was also reported in the area with goats said to be the most affected. Due to good harvest received last season, household food security situations was reported to be satisfactory as many households are reported to still dependent on their harvest for food access. However, the situation is feared to deteriorate soon amidst the poor expected agricultural production.

Okaku

As it was reported in other constituencies in the region, poor rainfall performance continued to dominate the 2018/2019-rainfall season. Sporadic and erratic rainfall patterns with frequent prolonged dry spells and high temperature were reported in the area. Average planted area is estimated at 55% of their crop fields. It was reported that farmers suffered poor crop germinations and have attempted to replant several time with limited or no success. Provisional crop estimates indicated a substantial reduction in the expected harvest with pearl millet production set to decline by 93% and sorghum is down by 87% of last season's harvest. Harvest outlook for non-cereals is also reported to be very poor because of the ongoing drought conditions. Isolated cases of false armyworms were reported in Eloolo village.

Grazing was reported to be poor in the common grazing area, but fair in the enclosure. No major livestock diseases were reported at the time of the assessment. Livestock body condition was noted to range between fair and poor. However, the situation is expected to deteriorate as drought conditions strengthen. Regarding the household food security situation, it was reported that majority of the household are still feeding from previous harvest which is estimated to sustain them until the next harvest. However, the situation is expected to worsen amidst the expected poor agricultural production.

Okatyali

According to a report from the Agricultural Extension office, the first half of the 2018/2019-rainfall season almost resembled that of the previous season except that, good rainfall was received in December compared to poor rainfall this season. To make the matter worse, frequent prolonged dry spells with erratic and sporadic rainfall patterns are still dominating the season. Majority of farmers are reported to have covered about 60% of their crop fields. However, crop germination is reported to be poor due to poor rainfall and many farmers attempted to replant many times with little to no success. Preliminary crop estimates indicated a sharp decrease in the expected harvest with pearl millet and sorghum production are estimated to decrease by 50% each of last season's harvest.

Grazing was reported to be poor in most area in the constituency, but fair to good in the cattle post areas. However, water supply was reported to be a challenge as most water catchments are dry due to lack of rainfall. No major livestock diseases were reported at the time of the assessment. Household food security situations were reported to be good since majority of households still have stock from previous harvest. However, the situation is expected to deteriorate amidst poor the expected poor agricultural production this year.

Uukwiyu

As it was reported in other constituencies in the region, poor rainfall performance was reported in

this area resulting in delayed cultivations. It was reported that productive rainfall was only realised in January as opposed to early November. It was noted that, even the rainfall started in January; the performance is still poor and characterised by frequent prolonged dry spells with erratic and sporadic patterns. Majority of farmers are reported to have covered about 70% of their crop fields. Preliminary crop estimates showed a significant reduction in the expected harvest with pearl millet set to decline by at least 70% and sorghum is down by 33% of last season's harvest. Moreover, harvest prospects for non-cereals was also said to be poor due to ongoing drought condition in the area. On the crop pests, cases of False Armyworms were widely reported in the area.

Grazing was reported to range between fair and poor with livestock body condition said to range between fair and good. Water supply in the area is said to become scarce, as most water catchment are dry. On the household food security, the situation is reported to be okay as most households are said to still dependent on their last season's harvest for food access. However, the situation is expected to deteriorate amidst the expected agricultural production this year.

Ohangwena region

Poor and below average crop production is highly likely, following a very poor rainfall performance for 2018/2019 rainy season. The region noted a very poor rainfall since the start of the 2018/2019-rainfall season in October last year and as a result; poor agricultural production can be expected. It was reported that, the season is characterised by sporadic and insufficient rainfall patterns with prolonged dry spells accompanied by high temperatures. Poor rainfall have caused poor crop germinations of which many farmers are reported to have attempted to replant several time with little or no success. It was reported that, frequent dry spells have caused crops and grass for grazing to wilt. Farmers are reported to have lost hope in the expected harvest optimistic which according to them is likely to be poor. Provisional crop estimates indicated a massive reduction in the expected harvest with aggregate cereal expected to drop by at least 68% of last season's harvest, and 62% below the average production. In particular, pearl millet production is estimated to decline by 68% below last season's harvest, and about 62% below the average production. Sorghum production is set to drop by 73% below last season's harvest and about 78% below the average production. Additionally, harvest outlook for non-cereals such legumes, melons and squash was also reported to be poor due to ongoing drought conditions in the region. Cases of False Armyworms were widely reported in the region, but the damage to crop is minimal. Average planted area is estimated at about 74% of the crop fields, reflecting a decrease of about 18% when compared with the corresponding period last year. Figure 10 below shows a summary of the preliminary harvest estimates in various parts of the region.

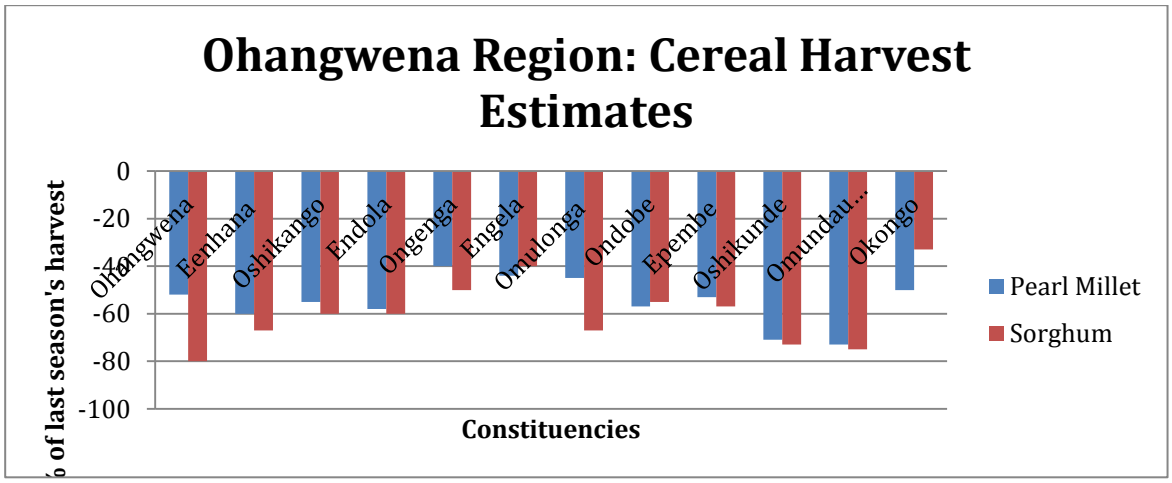


Figure 10: Summary of the cereal preliminary harvest estimates

Note: Harvest Estimates are highly conservative

No major livestock diseases were reported at the time of the assessment. However, cases of internal parasites were widely reported in the region. Grazing was reported to be poor and the situation is expected to deteriorate as drought conditions strengthen. Livestock body condition ranged between fair and poor. Water supply situation was noted to be a challenge as most of the water catchments are dry. The western part of the region is said to be the most affected are by poor grazing and water for livestock consumptions. Many farmers are reported to have started moving their livestock to the eastern part of the region for better grazing. On the household food security, the situation was reported to be satisfactory as most households are reportedly still dependent on last season's harvest for food access. However, the situation is expected to deteriorate amidst the expected poor agricultural production.

Constituencies

Ohangwena

Poor rainfall performance continues to be reported in various parts of the constituency and consequently farmers are facing very poor agricultural production this year. According to the Agricultural Extension officials in the constituency, since the beginning of the 2018/2019 rainfall season, rainfall performance has been poor and is characterised by sporadic and insufficient rainfall with high temperature. Nonetheless, majority of farmers are reported to have covered about 100% of their crop field of which on average only about 65% of the crop field where crop germination is successful. Preliminary crop estimates indicated massive reductions in the expected harvest with pearl millet estimated to decrease by at least 52% and sorghum is down by over 80% of last season's harvest. Apart from poor rainfall in the area, it was noted that, lack of basal dressing fertilizers was also one the factors that contributed to the expected poor crop harvest. Cases of False Armyworms were widely reported in the constituency.

No major livestock diseases were reported at the time of this report. Grazing was reported to range between poor and fair, as it is failing to establish properly due to drought condition. Household food security remained satisfactory as most households are reportedly still dependent on their last season's harvest for food access. However, the situation is expected to deteriorate with the expected poor harvest and some households are said to have started supplementing their harvest with market purchases in order to prolong the availability of their food stock.

Ongenga

Despite the good start of the 2018/2019 rainfall season in October last year, poor rainfall conditions continue to be reported in the constituency. According to official responsible for this area, lights to good showers were received end of November with no rain in December last year. It was reported that, light showers were also received

during January and February, which enable many farmers to cultivate about 60% of their crop fields. It was further reported that, some farmers did not cultivate because of the discouraging rainfall patterns. Moreover, it was noted that, no fertilizers received this season and quantity of seeds received this season was not enough because farmers has to replant several time with little or no success. Provisional crop estimates indicate a significant reduction in the expected harvest with pearl millet and sorghum production is estimated to decline by 40% and 50% of last season's harvest respectively. In addition, harvest prospects for none-cereals were also reported to be poor when compared with last season.

Grazing was reported to be poor with livestock body conditions said to range between fair and poor. However, water for livestock was reported to be satisfactory as most water catchments have water from last season and this season little inflow received. Household food security was reported to be satisfactory, but expected to weaken in a wake of the expected poor agricultural production due to drought conditions.

Eenhana

As it was reported in other constituencies in the region, this area is said to be affected by the poor rainfall, which has brought the 2018/2019 agricultural production to a halt. According to information from this area, rainfall performance has been extremely poor in the first half of the season, stretching to January and February. Under the circumstance, majority of farmers were only able to cover about 40% of their crop fields with most of the field noted poor crop germinations. Preliminary crop estimates showed a reduction in the expected harvest with pearl millet and sorghum production estimated to decrease by 60% and 67% of last season's harvest respectively. It was reported that improved seeds received at the ADC could not suffice due to the fact that farmers have to replant several times with limited or no success. In addition, it was reported that no fertilizers stock was received this season. Cases of False Armyworm were reported in the constituency.

Grazing was reported to be poor and some livestock especially cattle are reportedly succumbing to malnutrition. No major livestock diseases were reported at the time of the report. Water supply was reported to be poor in the area as most water catchment are dry and many farmers are dependent on pipeline to supply water to their livestock which is said to be costly. Household food security was reported to be fine, but expected to weaken amidst expected poor agricultural production.

Ondobe

Since the beginning of the 2018/2019-rainfall season in October last year, rainfall performance has been poor. According to the report from the agricultural extension official responsible for this area, poor rainfall was seen in the forms of erratic rainfall with prolonged dry season as well as high temperatures. The northern part of the constituency is said to be the hardest hit by the prevailing drought conditions. It was reported that, most farmers covered about 95% of their crop fields. However, it was further reported that, crop germination is poor and even those that germinated, the crop have started wilting due to poor rainfall being experienced in the area. Preliminary crop estimates indicated a significant reduction in the expected harvest with pearl millet and sorghum production estimated to decrease by 57% and 55% of last season's production. Moreover, harvest

outlook for non-cereals was also reported to be poor when compared with last season's production.

On the livestock health, no major livestock diseases were reported at the time of the assessment. However, minor cases of internal parasites in goats were reported in the area. Grazing was reported to be poor in the area with livestock condition reported to range between poor and fair. Moreover, surface water for livestock is said to be poor, as most swamps and earth dams did not received a significant water inflow this season. On the household food security, the situation was reported to be satisfactory as most households still depends on last season's harvest with some started supplementing g their harvest with market purchases.

Omulonga

As it was reported in other constituencies in the region, the 2018/2019-rainfall season was reported to be poor for this area. According to information from the agricultural officials responsible for this area, this season is characterised by erratic and insufficient rainfall coupled with prolonged dry spells and high temperature. Nonetheless, majority of farmers were able to cover up to 90% of their crop fields. Preliminary crop estimates indicated a massive reduction the expected harvest with pearl millet production estimated to decrease by over 44% and sorghum is down by 67% of last season's harvest. Moreover, harvest prospects for non-cereals were also reported to be poor, largely because of poor rainfall.

Cases of internal parasites in both small and large stock were reported in the constituency. Grazing was reported to be poor with livestock body condition reported to range between fair and poor. The household food security was reported to be satisfactory as most households are said to still dependent on their last season's harvest for food access.

Endola

Since the beginning of the 2018/2019 rainfall season in October last year, poor rainfall performance is said to have dominated the season. According to information from the agricultural extension official, the season is characterised by erratic and sporadic rainfall coupled with prolonged dry spells, accompanied by high temperatures. Average planted area is estimated at 88% of the cropping area. Preliminary crop estimates indicated a considerable reduction in the expected harvest with pearl millet production set to decline by at least 58% below last season's harvest. No information was available regarding the harvest outlook for sorghum production. Moreover, harvest outlook for non-cereals was reported to be much better than the previous season. Cases of false armyworms were reported in the area.

Grazing was reported to be poor with livestock body condition said to range between fair and poor. No major livestock diseases were reported at the time of compiling this report. On the household food security, the situation was reported to be satisfactory, but weakening. It was reported that, majority of the households are still dependent on own production which is currently being supplement with market purchases.

Oshikango

No Agricultural Extension official in this area, hence no report.

Engela

This constituency is said to have suffered the effects of poor rainfall performances since the start of the rainy season in October 2018. According to reports from the agricultural extension official responsible for this area, poor rainfall performance was seen in the forms of erratic and insufficient rainfall as well as prolonged dry season. Many farmers are reportedly attempted to replant several time with little or no success. Planted area is estimated at approximately 70% of the cropping area. Provisional crop estimates indicated a massive reduction in the expected harvest with pearl millet is set to decrease by 44% and sorghum is down by about 40% of last season's harvest. Cases of false armyworms were widely reported in the constituency.

No major livestock diseases were reported at the time of this report. Grazing is said to be affected by poor rainfall and was reported to be poor in most areas of the constituency. Livestock body condition was reported to be poor with some cattle reportedly dying due to malnutrition. On the household food security, the situation was reported to be satisfactory as most households are reportedly still dependent on their last season's harvest for food access. Government is requested to excavate earth dams in the area in order to retain water during the rainy season for later use during the dry season.

Okongo

Although this area use to receive better rainfall than other constituencies in the region, the area is not spared the impacts of poor rainfall this time as drought condition strengthen. The agricultural production is expected to be poor this year due to poor and below average rainfall experienced in the area. Preliminary crop estimates indicated a significant reduction in the expected harvest with pearl millet estimated to decline by 50% and sorghum is down by about 33% of last season's harvest. In addition, harvest prospects for non-cereals are also expected to yield poorly this season. An average planted area is estimated at 60% of the cropping area. Farmers were still waiting for the rainfall in order to finish ploughing their fields, while some have given up because of the nature of the rainfall this season which is very discouraging.

Grazing was reported to be in fair condition and may deteriorate if no further rainfall is received. Livestock body condition was reported to be good. On the livestock health, cases of Sweating Sickness and internal and external parasites were reported in the constituency. On the household food security the situation was reported to be oaky as most households are said to be dependent on own production for food access.

Omundaungilo

As it was reported in other constituencies in the region, this area also noted poor rainfall, which has affected the agricultural production. It was reported that, poor rainfall was seen in the forms of sporadic and insufficient rainfall with prolonged dry season. Average planted area is estimated at 85% of the cropping area. Provisional crop estimates indicated a substantial reduction in the expected harvest with pearl millet set to decrease by 73% and sorghum is down by over 75% of last season's harvest. Moreover, harvest outlook for non-cereals is also reported to be poor when compared with last season.

No major livestock diseases were reported at the time of this report. Livestock body condition was

reported to range between poor and fair while grazing is said to be poor. The water supply was reported to be satisfactory with earth dams and boreholes and wells being the main sources. On the household food security, the situation was reported to be okay as most households are reportedly still dependent on their own production for food access.

Epembe

Since the beginning of the 2018/2019-rainfall season, the constituency is reported to have experienced poor rainfall, affecting the agricultural production. It was reported that, the northern and eastern parts of the Constituency received relatively better rainfall compared to the southern and western parts of the constituency where very poor rainfall was received. Average planted area is estimated at about 40% of the cropping area. Provisional crop estimates indicated a significant reduction in the expected harvest with pearl millet production expected to decline by 53% and sorghum is down by 58% of last season's production. Additionally, harvest prospects for non-cereals is also said to be poor due to the prevailing drought conditions.

No major livestock diseases were reported at the time of this report. Grazing was reported to range between fair and poor and its establishment is affected by poor rainfall. Livestock body condition was reported to range between fair and poor state. On the household food security, the situation was reported to be satisfactory, following good harvest last season.

Oshikunde

As it was noted in other constituencies in the region, the 2018/2019-rainfall season was reported to be very poor, since the start in October 2018. Poor rainfall was seen in the forms of erratic and sporadic rainfall pattern with prolonged severe dry condition, accompanied by high temperatures. Majority of farmers use draught animals to cultivate their crop fields. Average planted area is estimated at 85% of the cropping area. Preliminary crop estimates indicated a considerable reduction in the expected harvest with Pearl millet production set to decrease by 71% while sorghum is expected to drop by at least 73% of the previous season's harvest. It was also reported that harvest prospects for non-cereal is also poor because of the ongoing drought condition in the area.

Grazing was reported to be poor throughout the constituency and the situation is expected to worsen if no further rains received before the rain season terminate. Livestock body condition was reported to range between fair and poor. With regard to household food security, the situation was reported to be okay as most households are said to still dependent on their last season's harvest for food access. However, the situation is expected to worsen soon as drought conditions strengthen.

Oshikoto region

The region is expecting a poor agricultural production due to extremely poor rainfall performance. Since the start of the 2018/2019-rainfall season is October last year, very poor rainfall was noted in various parts of the region affecting crop and livestock production as well as water sources. According to reports from the agricultural extension centres, poor rainfall was seen in the forms of sporadic and erratic rainfall patterns and frequent prolonged dry spells accompanied by high temperatures. Preliminary crop estimates indicated a substantial reduction in the expected harvest across the constituencies in region. Aggregate cereal showed a reduction of over 76% below last season's harvest and about 77% below the average production. In particular, pearl millet production is estimated to decline by more than 76% of last season's harvest and about 63% below the average production. Moreover, sorghum production is the hardest hit with estimated reduction of about 96% of last season's harvest and 98% below the average production. In addition, harvest outlook for non-cereals is said to be poor and far much lower than last season. Average planted area is estimated at 57% of the cropping area, which is about 30% lower than the same period last season. Figure 11 below shows a summary of the harvest estimates in various parts of the region.

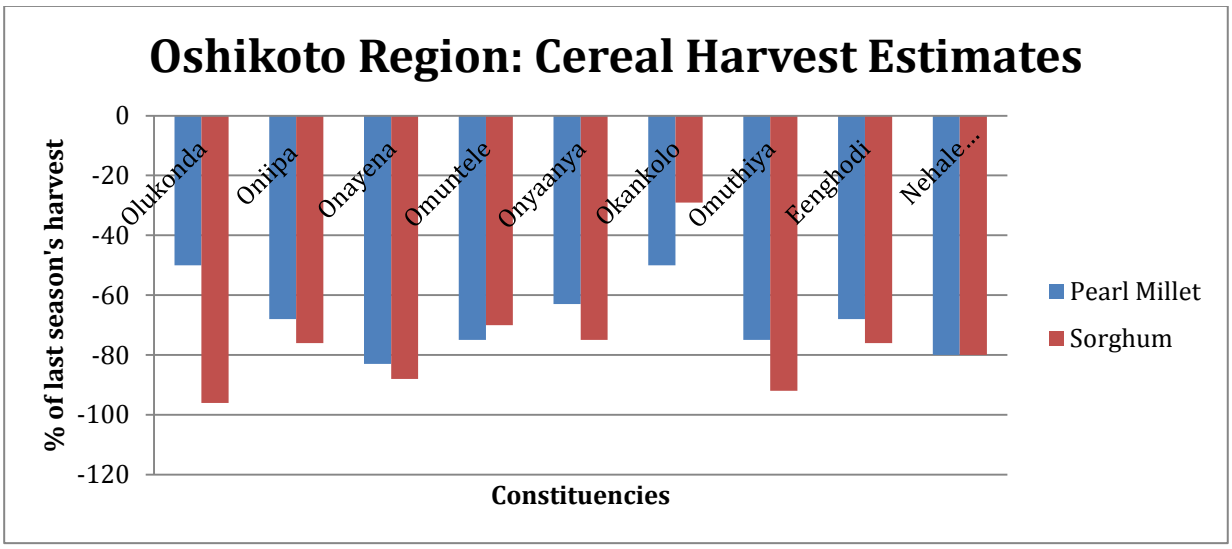


Figure 11: Summary of the cereal harvest estimates

Note: Harvest Estimates are highly conservative

No major livestock diseases were reported at the time of compiling this report. Grazing is reported to have deteriorated as drought conditions strengthen and was rated poor in most

parts of the region. Water availability, especially for livestock was reported to be poor as most water catchment has little or no water due to lack of rainfall. Household food security was noted to be satisfactory in the region, following a good agricultural production in the past two seasons. However, the situation is expected to weaken amidst the expected agricultural production this season.

Constituencies

Omuthiya

Poor rainfall condition has been reported since the start of the 2018/2019 last October. According to the agricultural extension official responsible for this area, poor rainfall was seen in the forms of delayed rainfall season, sporadic and erratic rainfall patterns with prolonged dry spells accompanied by high temperatures. It was reported that, majority of farmers were only able to cover about 50% of their crop fields compared to 90% of the same period last season. Preliminary crop estimates showed a significant drop in the expected harvest with pearl millet expected to decrease by at least 75% and sorghum is down by over 92% of last season's harvest. Moreover, harvest outlook for non-cereals is also said to be poor this season. It was noted that, much of the crop that germinated has since withered due to lack of moisture in the soil.

No major livestock diseases outbreaks were reported at the time of this report. Grazing continued to deteriorate in the area as drought conditions strengthen. The water supply especially for livestock consumption was reported to be a challenge as most earth dams are dry. Many farmers are reportedly using the pipeline to supply water to their livestock, which is expensive. With regards to household food security, the situation was noted to be fine as most households are reported to still dependent on last season's harvest for food access. However, the situation is expected to tighten by May this year, in light of the expected poor harvest.

Nehale LyaMpingana

Since the start of 2018/2019-rainfall season, rainfall has been poor across the constituency, affecting the agricultural productions and water supply. It was reported that, poor rainfall was seen in the forms of erratic and sporadic rainfall patterns with frequent prolonged dry spells accompanied by high temperatures. At the end of February 2019, majority of farmers are reported to have covered about 55% of their crop fields, reflecting a reduction of about 35% when compared to a corresponding period last year. Preliminary crop estimates indicated a significant reduction in the expected harvest with pearl millet and sorghum each set to decrease by about 80% of last season's production. Improved seeds and services were made available to farmers timely, but seeds were not enough due to the fact that farmers have to replant several times. No fertilizers stock was received in the constituency this season.

No major livestock diseases were reported at the time of this report. Grazing was reported to be poor in the area and the situation is said to be worsening due to lack of rain. Furthermore, water supply especially for livestock consumption was reported to be a challenge as many water catchments are dry and farmers are using wells to supply water to their

livestock. On household food security, the situation was noted to be satisfactory as majority of households are reportedly still dependent on their harvest for food access. However, the situation is expected to worsen amidst the expected poor agricultural production this season.

Oniipa

No technician, hence no report from this area.

Eenghodi

As it was reported in other Constituencies in the region, poor rainfall continued to dominate the season, affecting the agricultural production and water supply. According to the agricultural extension official responsible for this area, the 2018/2019 rainfall has been poor since the start of the rainy season in October 2018. It was reported that, poor rainfall was seen in the forms of delayed onset of the rainy season, erratic and sporadic rainfall patterns with prolonged dry spells accompanied by high temperatures. At the time of this report, majority of farmers are reported to have covered about 57% of their crop fields. Provisionally crop estimates showed substantial reduction in the expected harvest with pearl millet and sorghum estimated to decrease by over 78% and 76% of last season's harvest respectively. Moreover, harvest prospects for non-cereal crop are also said to be poor owing to poor rainfall received this season.

Grazing was reported to be poor and livestock body condition was noted to range between fair and poor. The water supply situation was reported to be a challenge as most water catchments are dry and farmers are dependent on their wells to supply water to their livestock. On household food security, the situation was reported to be satisfactory as most households are still dependent o their harvest for food access. However, the situation is expected to weaken amidst poor agricultural production expected this year.

Onayena

Poor rainfall was reported in this constituency and as a result, poor agricultural production is expected this year. Poor rainfall performance is seen in the forms of erratic and sporadic rainfall patterns with frequent prolonged dry spells which is accompanied by high temperature. Majority of farmers were able to cover about 50% of their crop fields. Crop harvest showed a gloomy outlook with pearl millet production set to decrease by 83% and sorghum is down by over 88% of last season's harvest. Furthermore, harvest outlook for non-cereals is also reported to be poor owing to poor rainfall experienced this season. No crop pests were reported in the constituency at the time of the assessment. The constituency reported shortages of basal dressing fertilizers, which was never been supplied this season.

Grazing continues to deteriorate as drought conditions strengthen. The water availability for livestock was also reported to be a problem as most water catchments were dry due to poor rainfall. No major livestock diseases were reported during the time of the assessment. Household food security was reported to be satisfactory as most households are still dependent on their last season's harvest for food access. However, the situation is expected to deteriorate with poor agricultural production expected this season.

Omuntele

Poor rainfall performance was reported across the Constituency, affecting agricultural production and water supply. According to a report from the agricultural extension official responsible for this the whole constituency is affected and as such grazing and water situation is worsening day by day. At the time of the assessment by the agricultural extension official, most farmers managed to cover up to 57% of their crop fields. Farmers are expecting poor crop harvest this season. It was reported that crop germinations is poor and farmers have planted several times with limited or no success. Preliminary crop estimates for this area indicate a considerable reduction in crop harvest with pearl millet production set to decline by 75 and sorghum is down by over 70% of last season's harvest. Moreover, harvest outlook for non-cereals was is also reported to be poor this season.

Grazing as well as water supply for livestock is reported to be worsening as many areas are dry and rainfall is not forthcoming. No livestock diseases were reported in the constituency at the time of this report. Household food security was noted to be okay as most households are still relying on their last season's harvest for food supply. However, the situation is expected to weaken amidst the expected poor harvest this season.

Onyaanya

As it was noted in other constituencies in the region, this area reported poor rainfall performance, affecting the agricultural production and water supply. According to a report from the agricultural extension official responsible for this area, since the start of the 2018/2019 rainfall season in October last year, rainfall has been extremely poor. It was reported that, rainfall has been erratic with sporadic patterns and frequent prolonged dry spells accompanied by high temperatures. Poor crop germination was noted and farmers are reported to have replanted several times with little or no success. Average planted area was reported to be about 75% of the cropping area. Preliminary crop estimates indicated massive reductions in the expected harvest with pearl millet set to decrease by at least 63% and sorghum is down by over 75% of last season's harvest. Moreover, harvest outlook for non-cereals was also reported to be very poor due to lack of rainfall in the area.

Grazing was reported to be poor and continue to deteriorate as drought conditions strengthen. Livestock body condition was noted to range between fair and poor and is expected to deteriorate if no further rainfall received before rainy season terminate. The water supply situation was also reported to be a challenge as most water catchments are dry due to lack of rain. Many farmers are reported to be using pipeline to supply water to their livestock. Household food security was noted to be satisfactory as most households are still dependent on their last season's harvest for food access. However, the situation is expected to weaken amidst the expected poor agricultural production.

NATIONAL CEREAL PRODUCTION SITUATION ANALYSIS FOR 2018/2019-CROPPING SEASON

Based on the assumption that good crop growing conditions prevail for the remainder of the season, the 2018/2019 aggregate cereal production is provisionally forecasted at 71,400 metric tons, reflecting a reduction of 53% of the last season's harvest, and 42% below the average production (see Table 4 below).

Table 4: Namibia: Cereal Production trend ('000 tonnes), 2018/2019 compared to a 20-year average (1998/1999 to 2017/2018) and 2018/2019 forecast harvest.

Region/Sector	2010/11	2011/12	2012/13	2013/14	2014/15	2015/16	2016/17	2017/18	2018/19	20-year average	2018/19 as % of average	2018/19 as % of 2017/18
Zambezi	5.7	5.6	3.5	7.5	2.5	2.1.	7.4	7.9	1.9	8.0	-77	-76
Kavango East & West	5.6	4.0	1.8	3.8	1.1	1.8	4.2	7.3	2.6	5.7	-55	-65
Omusati	11.1	12.6	3.2	7.4	3.3	4.7	13.1	21.7	3.4	15.4	-78	-84
Ohangwena	8.0	12.3	4.9	7.3	2.6	4.2	9.9	16.7	5.3	13.8	-62	-68
Oshana	5.0	13.6	4.4	8.9	3.3	2.2	20.1	16.0	2.3	9.1	-75	-86
Oshikoto	16.7	20.2	11.5	18.6	5.8	7.0	70.9	24.8	5.8	16.8	-66	-77
Commercial	59.5	75.2	87.3	82.6	50.5	52.2	80.3	58.5	50.4	53.79	-7	-14
Namibia	**111.7**	**143.4**	**116.6**	**136.1**	**68.9**	**74.4**	**137.5**	**152.9**	71.4	122.8	-42	-53

Table 4 above shows that, all the major crops producing areas are expecting substantial reductions in the expected cereal harvest which is significantly lower than last season, and below the average production. The major contributing factor for the poor and below average expected harvest is mainly the very poor rainfall performance in the dry land crop producing areas and to some extent the Fall Armyworms reported in the dry land communal maize producing areas.

Table 5: Namibia: Total planted area trend ('000 hectares) and 2018/2019 area planted estimates compared with a 20-year average (1998/1999 to 2017/2019) and 2017/2018 cropping season.

Region/Sector	2010/11	2011/12	2012/13	2013/14	2014/15	2015/16	2016/17	2017/18	2018/19	20-year average	2018/19 as % of average	2018/19 as % of 2017/18
Zambezi	20.9	20.1	20.6	19.4	20.4	15.4	20.1	18.9	12.1	21.7	-44	-36
Kavango East & West	23.1	20.6	20.6	21.6	18.4	17.4	21.8	19.6	13.6	19.8	-31	-30
Omusati	82.6	73.4	61.5	78.0	64.3	74.4	83.5	78.9	60.6	86.2	-30	-23
Ohangwena	85.2	84.3	76.2	79.8	65.5	75.3	86.1	80.7	66.4	84.9	-22	-18
Oshana	36.3	35.1	33.2	35.1	30.8	33.9	35.9	37.4	26.5	42.9	-38	-29
Oshikoto	62.0	60.1	54.1	58.1	54.8	56.1	60.1	57.4	37.6	66.3	-43	-34
Commercial	15.0	18.0	16.5	16.0	16.5	12.1	15.1	11.3	10.0	14.3	-30	-11
Namibia	**325.5**	**311.6**	**282.7**	**308.0**	**270.6**	**284.4**	**322.7**	**304.3**	226.9	336.4	-33	-25

Table 5 above shows the analysis of the planted area estimates. At the time of this report, aggregate planted area for cereal coarse grain as indicated in Table 5 above is estimated at 226, 900 hectares, reflecting a reduction of 25% of last season and 33% below the average planted area. The reduction is attributed largely to the general poor rainfall performance experienced this season. However, it is important to note that, ploughing and planting activities in the communal crop producing regions were still ongoing at the time of compiling this report; hence area cultivated is expected to increase.

CEREAL FOOD SUPPLY AND DEMAND SITUATION UPDATE

Table 6: Cereal supply and demand situation update

Namibia: Cereal Supply/Demand Forecast for 2018/2019 Marketing Year (May/April) ('000 metric tonnes)				
	Wheat	**Maize**	**Millet/Sorghum**	**Total**
Domestic Availability	**15.4**	**96.8**	**88.3**	**200.5**
Opening stocks (as at May 2018*)	9.3	37.6	0.7	47.6
Forecasted Production**	6.1	59.2	87.6	152.9
Total Utilization* **	**82.8**	**181.8**	**86.7**	**351.2**
Food use	72.5	165.8	58.6	296.9
Losses and other uses	0.3	5.9	13.1	19.4
Closing stocks (as at April 2018*)	10.0	10.0	15.0	35.0
Shortfall to be covered by import	**-67.4**	**-85.0**	**1.6**	**-150.8**
Commercial imports received	**89.4**	**32.9**	**1.0**	**123.3**
Commercial imports expected	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**
After trade Deficit/Surplus	**22.0**	**-52.1**	**2.6**	**-27.5**

*Notes: * Includes commercial, food aid and on-farm stocks*

*** Exclude cereal production for animal feed*

**** 2.4 million people (NSA, 2018 est.) each consuming 124kg of cereal per annum*

Source: National Early Warning on Food Security, Statistics and Business Information, MAWF

Table 6 above present the revised Food Balance Sheet, after commercial imports received in the country between May 2018 and February 2019 to cover the projected deficit. The table indicated that a total of 123, 300 metric tons of coarse grains were imported in the country. This indicates that, by end of February this year, the imports have only covered the deficit of wheat resulting in a surplus of 22,000 metric tons. Moreover, there was a surplus of pearl millet/sorghum, which is mainly pearl millet. The commercial millers and AMTA absorbed much of the pearl millet surplus for Strategic Food Reserve and business purpose respectively. Meanwhile, AMTA has closed the border for pearl millet imports since July 2018 till to date and farmers are still selling their pearl millet harvest to AMTA. There was also pearl millet import received because at the time of closing the border for import, commercial millers have already ordered their consignments form India, which takes at least 90 days to arrive in the country. However, there is still uncovered deficit for maize, which after trade deficit/surplus still showing a shortage of 52,100 metric tons. The uncovered deficit under normal circumstance is covered through additional commercial imports.

CONCLUSION AND RECOMENDATIONS

Conclusion

The 2018/2019-rainfall season has been extremely poor and was seen in the forms of delayed onset of the rainfall season, sporadic and erratic rainfall patterns as well as frequent prolonged dry spells compounded by extremely high temperatures that exacerbated evaporation of the little moisture received. This is said to have affected the agricultural production and water resources.

Provisional crop estimates, indicated that all crop-producing areas are expecting a massive reduction in the expected harvest. Cereal production is estimated to have reduced by 70 to 80 percent in the communal area and by 15% in the commercial area below last season's harvest. Aggregate cereal production shows that, the country is expecting a substantial reduction in harvest of at least 53% of last season's harvest and over 42% below the average production.

Household food security remained satisfactory in most regions of the country, following good improvements in agricultural production recorded in the last two seasons. However, pockets of food insecurity are also still being reported in various areas especially those that suffered poor agricultural production as a result of prolonged dry spells or floods during the 2017/2018 rainfall season coupled with the current ongoing drought conditions in the country.

Grazing conditions continue to deteriorate in most parts of the country amidst poor and below average rainfall currently being experienced countrywide. In most areas, grazing is reported to vary between fair and very poor. Water availability for both livestock and humans continue to be a problem in some parts of the country due to late and poor rainfall performance experienced since the beginning of the rainfall season.

Recommendations

Based on the above-mentioned findings, the following recommendations are made for possible assistance and to improve the upcoming 2019/2020 agricultural production:

- Government should implement the drought relief measures without delay in order to provide the much-needed reliefs to communities affected by drought.

- Regional Councils with the assistance of traditional leaders (village headmen) are advised to identify the most vulnerable and food insecure people to benefit from the drought relief measures.
- Government should speed up the renovations of the abattoirs North of Veterinary Cordon Fence to enable farmers to[54]sell their livestock through formal market channels.
- Directorate of Agriculture Production Extension, and Engineering Services is requested to:
    - Continue advising farmers to prepare for a drought by taking the necessary precautionary measures such as de-stocking, culling, etc.
    - Ensure timely provision of sufficient basic inputs and services for the upcoming 2019/2020 agricultural season.

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- Directorate of Agriculture Production, Extension & Engineering Services (DAPEES)
- Directorate of Agricultural Research and development (DARD)
- Directorate of Veterinary Services (DVS)
- Agricultural Business Development (AGRIBUSDEV)
- Agricultural Marketing and Trade Agency (AMTA)
- Namibian Agronomic Board (NAB)
- Northern Namibia Farmers Seed Growers' Cooperative
- Likwama Farmers Association
- Meteorological Services of Namibia
- Directorate Disaster Risk Management (DDRM)
- Namibia Statistics Agency (NSA)
- Regional Councils

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